Legacy

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/47197402.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

Categories:
F/F, F/M

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Perfuma/Scorpia (She-Ra), Entrapta/Hordak (She-Ra), Mermista/Sea Hawk (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Finn | Adora/Catra Child (She-Ra), Original Child Character(s), Perfuma (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Mermista (She-Ra), Sea Hawk (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), Original Characters, Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Pregnant Adora (She-Ra), Protective Catra (She-Ra), Family Fluff, Family Secrets, Family Bonding, Halfmoon (She-Ra), Royal Advisor Catra, Glimmer loves being an aunt, Bow Is a Good Friend (She-Ra), They're In Love Your Honor, Catra Has Abandonment Issues (She-Ra), Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder - PTSD, Catra is a Princess/Prince, Adora is a Dork (She-Ra), Adorable Adora (She-Ra), Catra is a Dork (She-Ra), Catra is Named C'yra (She-Ra), Catra has Dads, Parents Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Soft Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Warning: Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

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Part 2 of After the War

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by AstrynSerene

Summary

Family is something that has always been important to both Catra and Adora, especially once the war ended. Once she'd healed and settled into life with her fiancé, Adora dove into trying to learn as much about Magicats as she could, wanting to know where Catra really came from, despite Catra's protests that it wasn't necessary. When Glimmer tells Adora about an abandoned Island called Halfmoon, the blonde insisted that they take a visit.

Little did they know just how much their lives would change with that one simple trip.

Notes

I am SO excited to finally be posting this! I hope the twists and turns and family fluff are the sequel you all come to love as much as I do! Chapters will be posted every Monday!

The Treasure in Halfmoon

Magicats were an extremely rare species, practically extinct save for Catra as far as everyone knew. Since the ending of the war, Adora had done everything she could to research anything and everything to try and find out where Catra came from or who her family was- despite the feline's assurance that it wasn't necessary.

"You are my family, Adora. Any random people we might find haven't been there for me like you have."

Still- Adora wanted to try. Even if they never met another magicat, maybe learning more about them would help them in the future. Of course- she was right, she just didn't realize how or how much it would until it slapped them in the face.

⚔

"Sooo.. What exactly happened here?" Catra raised an eyebrow, stepping forward to survey the ruins of what had been a kingdom long ago.

"Honestly, I couldn't tell you," Glimmer sighed, lightly kicking a pebble, "All I know is this used to be the kingdom of Halfmoon. It was small, the smallest actually, just this island in the delicate in between of Salineas and the Northern Reach, but- something happened, I'm guessing battle, probably when we were teenagers, that drove it to ruin."

"I mean- yeah, I got that. I guess I more or less meant what are we doing here?" The brunette crossed her arms loosely.

"Right- well.. I figured maybe we could find something about the island's history, maybe figure out if anyone who used to live here is still alive. We're slowly rehabilitating the Fright-" the queen cleared her throat, "The Scorpioni Kingdom, so I was kinda hoping we could try to do the same here… Besides, this is the only mission I can safely give Adora that doesn't involve labor because she's so persistent."

"Hey! I'm only three months pregnant, I'm not useless." Adora huffed, calming down only when she felt her fiancé's arms wrap around her waist.

"Never said you were."

"It's a nice thought, Sparkles, but there are actually people who inhabit Scorpioni. Here… not so much." Catra replied, keeping a hand on the small of Adora's back.

"Well, even if we can't do that, it'll still be nice to learn what we can about this place. The only other people we can ask are dad and Aunt Casta, and even their knowledge is limited."

"Well, we aren't gonna learn anything just standing here!" Adora mused as they made their way across the bare lands toward what looked like an old temple or castle of some sorts. Since the magic of Etheria was restored, the island was filled with the life of nature, but the remaining buildings were still dilapidated and abandoned.

"Whoa…" Bow's eyes widened as the squad wandered carefully into what seemed to be the main building. Old curtains covered the windows, all vivid in color and various in pattern. Torn tapestries hung along the walls, all with the same symbol shaped like something so familiar, yet the archer couldn't place exactly what.

"Do you think there's a library here?" Adora wondered out loud, running her fingers delicately across one of the tapestries.

"I'm sure there is somewhere," Catra shrugged, staring at the tapestries for a moment herself, "Huh."

"What?" The blonde turned towards her partner, raising an eyebrow.

"Nothing, just- weird symbol, I guess."

"I guess so?" Adora too shrugged, turning to try and scout the area more, only to stumble over Melog, who'd taken that moment

to uncloak themselves, "Whoa! Careful there, buddy. What's got you in a rush?" She chuckled, patting them on the head.

Melog only meowed in apology before hurrying over to Catra and biting her shirt to try and pull her along.

"Oh- jeez, bud, what's the matter?" Melog mewled, urgency filling their tone, "Wha- okay slow down. Just- show me!"

"What is it?" Glimmer asked.

"They wanna show me something, apparently very important. You guys keep looking for a library or whatever, I'll find you."

"Be careful," Adora automatically said, blushing when she received a kiss on the cheek, "Don't be long..?" She added, her clingy tendencies rising up in somewhere unfamiliar.

"You too, and I won't be, princess." The magicat smiled, before bounding off after Melog, already heading off to lead Catra where they wanted her.

⚔

It took a few minutes of wandering before the squad found a room that clearly used to be a library. Unfortunately, with a missing wall and half the roof caved in on one side, there wasn't too much left to scavenge.

"Well, this is- something." Adora bit her lip, glancing around at the remaining books on the floor and few surviving shelves.

"It's better than nothing," Glimmer sighed, picking up the first book she could and skimming it for anything useful. Bow did the same thing, but Adora decided to look through the desk that was placed just a little ways in front of the broken fireplace.

Not much caught her eye, papers, pens, a few random maps… She was almost ready to move on when a photograph caught her attention. Her eyes widened when she realized that it wasn't just some random people in the photo- but magicats! A couple, two men, holding an infant, though the bottom half of the picture was torn, so Adora couldn't see the baby's face. Still, as if proof of magicats wasn't enough, the men were wearing crowns, meaning they ruled here! This- this could be the island Catra was born on!

"Guys! I think this island belonged to-" The princess abruptly cut herself off when she looked up and gasped, "Catra..?"

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"Okay seriously, buddy, what is it?" Catra laughed, following her companion outside.

" *Trust me, kit. This is very important! Just over here!* " Melog meowed.

Catra didn't think she would ever get used to being called that, even almost three years later. She only nodded and rounded the corner to a small clearing, a campsite maybe? There were tents, a firepit with somewhat fresh ashes inside, and a crate that Melog was sniffing at with great urgency. Catra scoffed, approaching slowly, "Melog, did you really drag me out here because you found some treats or some… thing…" she trailed off when she was met with a baby. Not just a baby, but a kitten. A magicat kitten! Her jaw dropped as she crouched down to get a closer look. The kitten hadn't even seemed to open their eyes yet. A tiny tuft of brown hair was on their head, their little arms grabbing blindly as they sniffed for someone to cuddle with for warmth. Little cries escaped, clearly hungry. They were way too thin.

"Stars… you poor thing who- who would-" Shaking her head, ignoring all scenarios of how this poor kitten wound up abandoned here, she gently scooped the baby into her arms, cradling them close to her chest.

The reaction was instantaneous. The kitten relaxed upon feeling warmth and the rumble of Catra's purr, "I've gotchu.. It's okay…" she whispered, cradling them as close as she could, "You look too old to still have your eyes closed, little one…" her heart ached. There was no telling how long they'd been there or what they'd gone through beforehand. They looked to be almost six months old or so, give or take, "Come on, we need to get you to

Brightmoon, fed, bathed- oh jeez-" the brunette quickly hurried back towards the castle, "Thank you Melog, so much!" She called quickly, "Get to the ship, we'll be there soon!"

Meowing, Melog rushed off towards Darla, knowing they had to be ready to fly back to Brightmoon as soon as possible.

Wasting no time, Catra hurried back into the castle. She found the library fairly quickly when her senses picked up movement nearby. Following Adora's scent helped as well. She arrived just as Adora spoke up again, "Guys, I think this island belongs to-" the princess trailed off as she looked up, gasping when she saw her fiancé with a baby, "Catra..?"

"H-Hey, Adora…"

"Who..?"

"Melog found them in an abandoned box… I.. I didn't know what else to do.." Reality sunk in, and Adora's arms were around her before her knees hit the floor.

"And… And you're positive they were alone?" Glimmer asked, crouching down with Bow next to the couple.

Catra nodded, "The campsite was clearly abandoned, I'm not sure how much longer this kit would.. we need to go home. Now."

"Right, of course!"

Once on their feet, the squad hurried back to the ship, the urgency to get home higher than they'd ever anticipated.

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"Guys you need to sit down, especially you Adora!" Glimmer demanded, hand on her hip.

"I'm worried, Glimmer! That baby was dying and the second they took them from me they started crying! I need- I just-" Catra's breath hitched when she felt Bow pull her into his arms.

"Catra, we understand you both have extremely high maternal instincts going on right now. You've already got a kitten on the way and now a second has just appeared, it's okay to be scared and attached. Clearly the poor thing was abandoned, and now they will have you, but you've got to let the doctors make sure the baby lives through the night."

Tears finally ran down Catra's face, sobs escaping as she gripped onto her friend's shoulders, "I saw myself in them, Bow… that's exactly what happened to me… I was left alone in a box a-and if Adora hadn't found me-"

"-Hey hey…" Adora cut in, having finally pushed Glimmer off enough to approach. She gently took Catra's hand, not wanting to pull her from their friend's hold, "I'm scared too, but at least we found them. They're gonna grow up alongside the kitten I'm carrying, surrounded in more love then they'll know what to do with."

"O-Okay…yeah.." Catra sniffed, wiping her eyes with her palm.

The group looked up when the door to the infirmary opened and a doctor, Althea, stepped out.

"How are they?!" Catra asked, ripping herself out of Bow's arms.

"She's doing good, all things considered." Althea smiled, "The poor baby was very lucky you found her, I know she'll be in good hands with you two."

"Can we see her?" Adora asked, gently gripping onto Catra's arm.

"I can only allow you and Catra too at the moment, since you're her only official guardians at the moment. I'm guessing you'll be adopting her?"

"Of course we will," Catra replied immediately.

"Well, we'll be waiting just out here." Glimmer promised, the four sharing a hug before the couple followed the doctor into the infirmary.

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Catra and Adora gasped when they approached the medical bassinet the kitten was laying in. The little one had several IVs in her arms and a little oxygen mask over her mouth and nose. She had been given a fresh diaper and had a blanket covering her small form for warmth. Her little ears were pinned tightly to her head and her eyes had yet to show signs of opening.

Both women felt their hearts ache at the sight before them. How could anyone leave such a sweet kitten alone to die like this? It was beyond either of their comprehensions, "Althea said she, so..born female. Are we gonna use the same rules we came up with for this one?" Adora asked, placing a hand on her abdomen.

"I said I didn't want our kids defined by their junk, and I meant it." Catra hummed, "Though, since both have been used, what if we use she/they until she can decide what they want?"

Smiling, Adora wrapped her arms around her fiancé, resting her head on top of Catra's, "Sounds perfect to me." Using her free hand, she gently held her finger near the kitten's, her heart swelling with joy when the infant latched onto it almost immediately, beginning to sniff it and label the scent.

Catra found herself also smiling at the sight, beginning to purr softly, "She's beautiful…"

"She kinda looks like you…brown hair, the little stripes on their cheeks and arms…"

"I wonder what color their eyes are." Catra carefully ran her hand through the baby's tufts of hair, tearing up when she began purring and chirping at the affection, "You're gonna be so loved, kitten…" Catra whispered, careful to avoid messing with the IVs.

"Ladies..?" The couple looked back when Althea approached, "I need to do a little paperwork for you, have you got a name for this little sweetheart?"

The two exchanged looks, having a silent conversation before turning back to the doctor.

"Mara."

Intensive Care

Chapter Summary

Mara is safe in the intensive care unit of the Brightmoon Palace, but she's not out of the woods yet. Catra and Adora are doing their best to keep her happy and comfortable throughout the medical treatments they need, but there's a few anomalies that are raising a few concerns..

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra took a deep breath as she stared at the ceiling, listening to the heart monitor attached to her new daughter. It was steadier now than it was last night, but she knew they were probably a week out from being released from the ICU at least. The couple had been given a private room in the wing so they could stay with the baby until she was well enough to go home.

Tiny mewls from the bassinet caught Catra's attention. She carefully sat up, so as to not wake Adora, before turning towards the kit. She'd requested Mara be placed on her side, wanting Adora to be able to rest, and admittedly, because she felt such a vice gripping attachment to the baby already. She couldn't imagine how she was going to be when she had *two* kittens in her life.

"What's the matter, sweetie..?" She whispered, offering her finger for comfort after sheathing her claws.

Mara whimpered, gripping onto her finger as tight as her little hand could. Catra could feel her itty bitty claws digging into her finger, "I wish I could hold you baby but I don't wanna mess up your IVs and hurt you…" Tears welled up in Catra's eyes as Mara whimpered again, sniffing around and trying to pull Catra's hand as close as possible, "Who did this to you..?" Catra managed before a sob escaped, covering her mouth with her free hand.

"Catra..?" Adora mumbled, sitting up and rubbing her eyes, "Is everything okay..?"

"No, Adora, it's not okay." Catra gasped, looking at her fiancé when she scooted over next to her, "Look at her, Adora. She's surviving on medically injected nutrients and oxygen and they're *terrified* . We don't know how long she was in that box alone, starving and mewling for help. Whoever had this kitten clearly didn't treat her right. She's gotta be almost six months old and she hasn't even opened her eyes yet! They should have opened months ago!"

"Baby, calm down…" Adora wrapped her arms around her, kissing her cheek, her lips lingering for a moment, "We may *never* know what made Mara wind up in that box, okay? But we *do* know that now she's safe with us. They're going to heal and grow up and be happy, safe, and *loved* . We are going to be there for every step of her development."

Slowly, Catra nodded, sniffling, "Okay…"

Mara whined again, now both of her little hands reaching towards the new scent she was associating with safety.

"Shhhh, it's okay, little one…" Adora whispered, cupping Mara's face and allowing her to hug her wrist and hand with her arms and legs.

"I wanna hold her again…" Catra mumbled, a few tears still running down her face.

"I'm sure we could. I think we should get a nurse to help the first time so we know how to handle all of the wires though."

Nodding, Catra looked over to the bedside table and pressed the non-emergency call button.

"Is everything okay?" A nurse, Sage, asked as she quietly stepped into the room a few minutes later.

"I know it's late, but Mara is getting fussy and Catra wants to hold her. Would it be okay for you to show us how to do so safely?" Adora asked.

"Of course, I apologize, we would have sooner but we weren't sure how stable she would remain. She's actually doing quite well responding to her treatments and medications." Sage smiled, approaching the bedside and bassinet.

"Okay, little one, momma's gonna hold you now, so I gotta pull away," Adora explained, before carefully pulling her hand away and scooting back to her side of the bed so Catra could get situated as well.

Almost instantly, Mara whined and started crying, "Don't worry, baby, it's just for a moment…" Sage hummed, "Alright so when you pick them up do so like this.." She carefully slid her hand under the kitten's bottom and head from the ends of the bassinet, avoiding the wires as she lifted her up and into Catra's arms, "I advise you not to leave the bed with her for now, her IV stand won't need to be moved if you keep her in this area. We'll work on weening her off the IV and mobility over the next few days."

"Thank you…" Catra whispered, cradling Mara to her chest as she relaxed in bed. The kitten's cries quickly reduced to whimpers, then sniffles as she sniffed her chest and attached her claws to Catra's shirt, "There you go, momma's right here…"

"If you two need anything else, just call. I'll be here until the first moon's rise."

"Thank you so much, Sage." Adora smiled, waving as the nurse quietly slipped out, closing the door behind her. The blonde glanced over at her fiancé and gasped, "Awe.."

Mara was nestled in close, both of her claws holding onto Catra's shirt or her fur, her nose twitching while she was covered by the

blanket, babbling softly. Both the baby and Catra were purring now.

"You two… Stars what will I do when I have three purring furballs?" Adora snorted, leaning her head on Catra's shoulder.

"Sweat."

"Gh- ew, Catra.." Adora chuckled, reaching a hand up and placing it on Mara's back. The kitten sniffed the air momentarily before calming down, "I love you, both of you…"

"I love you too, Adora," Catra hummed, kissing the top of her head before doing the same to Mara, "And you too, Mara." The kitten trilled in response, making the latter giggle.

"We should sleep, you know. We have a long day of doctor's appointments, now both mine and Mara's."

"I know. You go on to sleep, I'm gonna make sure she is before I even try to put her back."

"Okay…" Adora leaned up and kissed Catra's cheek and Mara's before laying back down. Catra heard her snoring moments later.

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Adora woke up to the sound of the heart monitor and steady purring to her left. She looked over and smiled; Catra was asleep, propped up against a couple of pillows, still cradling Mara to her chest. The infant was kneading at Catra's chest in her sleep.

Yawning, Adora sat up, stretching gently before reaching over and rubbing Catra's thigh, "Catraa.."

"Mm..?" The brunette groaned, shifting slightly to keep Mara comfortable as she opened her eyes, "Morning…" she yawned, looking down at her daughter.

"She slept through the night after you picked her up."

Catra smiled, gently petting Mara behind her little ears, "Good… she needed the rest.."

The infant cooed, babbling softly as she slowly woke up, sniffing around before settling back against Catra's chest.

"I wish she would open her eyes…" Adora frowned, snuggling up to her fiancé, resting her head on her shoulder.

"I'm gonna ask Althea about it today…" Catra bit her lip, watching their daughter knead at her shirt, "I'm worried…"

"I am too, love." Adora rested her hand against the top of Mara's hand, drawing a giggle from the latter, "At least she's comfortable with us.."

"We're probably the only people who've ever treated them with any love or respect, Adora.." Catra sniffed, willing herself not to cry again.

"I know I just…try not to think about it, at least not right now.."

A gentle knock at the door gathered the couple's attention, "Come in." Catra called, smiling slightly when Althea entered the room.

"Good morning, did she sleep well through the night?"

"Only after Catra cradled her. She's been calm ever since." Adora explained, sitting up and grabbing a hair tie out of her bag by the bed and pulling up half of it into a messy bun.

"I figured that would happen," the doctor sighed, "The poor thing has very clear signs of trauma I'm glad she no longer has to live through."

"Speaking of.. She should have opened her eyes months ago.. Can we try to figure out why she can't or hasn't?"

"Of course, that was a concern I've picked up on as well. Can we lay her back in the bassinet for a few minutes?"

Though hesitant, Catra was determined to get Mara to a healthy state where they could be taken home and raised in a loving environment. So, she carefully got up to stand next to the bassinet, "Alright sweetheart, I have to set you down now, but I'll be right here, mommy will too…" she whispered, kissing Mara's forehead before laying her in the bassinet.

Mara immediately began to whimper and clung to Catra's offered finger. The brunette resisted the urge to scoop the kitten right back into her arms and shield her from anything and everyone.

"Deep breaths…" Adora calmly said, placing her hands on Catra's shoulders once she'd made her way to the other side of the bed. Catra only nodded.

Althea finally approached the bassinet after washing her hands and getting a pair of gloves, "Okay, so her charts are doing very well. She's responded perfectly to the treatments and medicine. I think we'll be able to ween her onto a bottle tonight, and hopefully within a few days be able to remove the other IVs as well. Obviously we were able to take her off oxygen last night already. Like you mentioned, her eyes are still closed however, and I think that's the biggest concern. I'm not sure if she's just refusing to because of something she went through or if there's

like some gunk or something kinda keeping them closed." Althea gently placed a finger under Mara's left eye to try and examine it, only for the kitten to hiss and claw at the finger until she pulled away.

"Oh, baby it's okay!" Adora promised, caressing the baby's hair gently to calm her down, as she'd begun shaking, "Althea is here to help you. We promise she won't hurt you…"

"It's alright, I should have expected that, all things considered," Althea chuckled, "Here, after she's calmed down, why don't one of you very gently pull down here under her eye, that way we can see if there's something there or not." The doctor explained, demonstrating on herself.

Catra immediately turned to Adora, "You do it, you don't have claws."

"Catra, you can sheath them-"

"- I know, I know, just.. please."

"..Okay," Adora nodded, kissing her cheek before looking down at Mara, who'd calmed down from her mothers' hold and touch, "Alright, little one, let's try this again…" Carefully, Adora copied the same movements, barely pressing down against Mara's cheek before pulling down just enough for them to get a look. Sure

enough, something, it looked like a mix of tears and eye crust to Adora, was there, the bottom of yellow eyes just barely visible.

"Okay, I think just a q-tip should be able to clean that up," Althea said, before moving across the room to grab one. Adora moved her finger in the meantime, noticing Mara squirming in discomfort.

"Do you think she has two yellow eyes, or heterochromia like you?" Adora asked.

Catra only shrugged, "I don't know… I might be convinced I somehow birthed her if she has my exact eyes." She joked, "But I'm pretty sure they're both yellow."

"Why don't we find out?" Althea smiled, walking back up to the couple, "I'm sure she'll only cry if I try, if I guide you Adora, can you do it?"

The blonde tensed, but slowly took the q-tips offered, "Just- walk me through it.."

"Okay, Catra, if you could carefully hold her eyelid up a little, Adora should be able to clean her up. Just focus on one side at a time, and you'll be fine. Take a break if she gets fussy. I wet the swabs with warm water so it'll make the job easier."

Nodding, Catra carefully placed the pad of her finger onto Mara's left eyelid, lifting it just enough for Adora to have access to clean her under eye.

They repeated the process on the other side, pausing when Mara would squirm or swat at them with her claws. Something was off to Catra though. She couldn't understand how crying and eye gunk would keep her from opening her eyes. Once the job was done she looked up at the doctor, "Can we have these tested to find out exactly what it is? It may be nothing but just… humor me?"

"Of course. I'll have them sent for testing immediately." Althea smiled, taking the swabs and putting them in small plastic bags.

"Catra..!" Adora gasped, grabbing her arm suddenly.

"What-" Catra froze when she looked down. Sure enough, Mara had opened her eyes. She was squinting a little, and her eyes were a bit red, but her beautiful yellow eyes were staring up at them, curious and innocent, "Hey there, baby…" Catra whispered, being careful as she picked Mara up, cradling her close. Mara babbled, sniffing around and beginning to knead on Catra's shirt. Tears ran down both women's cheeks, matching smiles adorning their faces.

"Don't forget Adora, you have an appointment with Doctor Fauna in a couple of hours. I'll see you two tonight?"

"Yes, thank you- so much." Adora sniffed, wiping her eyes as she watched the doctor nod and take her leave, "I'll have Glimmer or Bow accompany me to my appointment."

"What?" Catra furrowed her eyebrows, looking up as her fiancé moved away to find something to wear for the day.

"I know you wanna stay with Mara, Catra. I'll be alright. The ultrasounds don't show much right now anyway and I can relay any information about my medication and exercises."

Guilt made its way onto Catra's face. Her ears pinned against her head, "Are you sure?"

"I'm sure, love." Adora smiled, grabbing a shirt out of her bag, "I'd feel better knowing you were with her anyway, and I'll be just down the hall."

"Okay…" Catra took a deep breath, sitting back down on the cot they'd been sharing.

Once dressed in an oversized shirt and some sweatpants, Adora took a seat next to Catra and kissed her cheek, "I love you."

"I love you too, dummy." Catra hummed, giggling when she saw Mara poking at the golden band on her ring finger. The word "promise" was engraved in First One's across the top. A blush

lined her cheeks whenever she thought about Adora making it for her.

"I'm glad her eyes are open now. I still find it weird though. I mean her eyes are a little red…"

"Yeah.." The brunette sighed, "Maybe it's nothing, but it concerns me too."

"I guess we'll find out soon. Hungry? I'm gonna go down to the kitchen."

Catra couldn't stop the snort that escaped, "Sure. Surprise me."

"Okay!" Getting to her feet, the blonde gave both her babies a kiss on the head before heading down to the kitchen to find food and hopefully her friends so she could catch them up on Mara.

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Adora grunted as she laid back on the chair next to the ultrasound machine.

"Everything okay, Adora?" Glimmer asked, placing a hand on top of her friend's.

"Yeah, I'm fine. Just- careful."

"I understand. I know you're also used to having Catra with you."

"She needs to be with Mara right now, and I know that. I'm okay, I promise."

"Adora…" Glimmer furrowed her eyebrows, "I know something is bothering you. If not being away from Catra then.. what?"

"I…" The blonde sighed, looking down and fidgeting with her fingers, "I don't know, Glimmer. I'm stressed out because of Mara's condition, mine, and Catra's. We were expecting to have like- six to seven more months to prepare for parenthood, and suddenly we have a baby girl that's- that's sick and mentally traumatized! She and Catra both have separation anxiety from each other because Catra sees herself so much in that little kitten, Glimmer. All of that… worries me. I'm putting stress on the baby because I'm worried Catra's attention is going to get- too divided-
"

"-Oh, Adora don't think like that!" The queen quickly wiped away Adora's oncoming tears, "Catra is- surprisingly the most family oriented person I know. Right now, you're both stressed and scared because Mara is in a tough spot, but she's getting better, and soon you three will be back at your home in the woods. Okay?" Slowly, the blonde nodded, sniffing, "So don't put stress on yourself or this baby. We're all here for you, *especially* Catra.

The love she has for you is beautiful, and.. kinda gross sometimes."

"Ghm- shut up…" Adora blushed, shoving Glimmer slightly with a short laugh.

"You know I'm right. Stars I cannot *imagine* how protective she's gonna be once you're in later trimesters."

Adora only blushed harder, grateful for the subject change once Doctor Fauna entered the room, "Good morning your majesty, and Princess Adora. How's everything going?"

"Good, a bit of stress.."

"Considering the situation in the ICU, I'm not surprised. I've heard good things about Mara though, so I wouldn't be too worried. Now, let's do a medicine check and take some ultrasounds, shall we?"

⚔

Adora couldn't keep the smile off her face as she was guided down the hallway by Glimmer, her eyes trained on the ultrasound photos in her hand.

"The baby has barely begun forming, Adora, what are you staring at?" Glimmer teased.

"Hey, I know my kitten is there, and that's enough for me."

"Well, you can stare at them all night when you aren't walking around like this."

Sticking her tongue out in defiance, Adora giggled as she stepped through the door to their room, "Catra?"

"Hey, Adora." Catra hummed, smiling at her fiancé, "How'd it go?"

"All is good, I got new ultrasound photos.."

"Awe, that's great!"

"How's Mara?"

Catra turned towards the bassinet. Althea had just left the room a few moments prior, "She had a few.. moments in her appointment, but overall, she's looking so much better than when we found her."

“Moments?” Adora frowned, approaching her fiancé.

“She might’ve bit Doctor Althea.”

Adora snorted, “Oh..” Looking down at the sleeping kitten, the blonde sighed and shook her head.

“I can’t believe you two were ever worried about being parents.” Glimmer teased, crossing her arms.

“They haven’t started walking yet, Sparkles.” Catra returned.

“I have faith in you for once. Anyway, I’ll see you two for dinner, I have some meetings to get to.”

“Thanks for coming with me.” Adora smiled, waving at her friend, who nodded, before she teleported from the room.

Now alone, Catra sighed, and turned towards her partner, gently enveloping her in a hug, "I miss our home so much…"

"Me too, love." Adora frowned, running her fingers gingerly through Catra's mane. The blonde had been so happy when her fiancé decided to grow it back out. More for her to fidget with, (and it was really pretty!) "We'll get to go home soon, I'm sure of

it. She's improved so much more than we thought she would in what, two days? They're a strong kitten."

"I know, I guess I'm just impatient. I mean, we were preparing for one baby, now we have to remodel the nursery for two!"

Snorting, Adora kissed Catra's forehead, "I think that'll be the least of our worries. Now, can we lay down? I wanna show you these photos."

Eyes lighting up, Catra nodded, and the two laid back down on the cot, cuddling up to look at the ultrasounds while their daughter took a much needed nap.

Chapter End Notes

I'm going to be slowly revealing/dropping hints about what happened to Mara and bits of her history. Comments with speculation about what happened to them are welcome! I'm curious if people picked up on the eye situation. It's.. not pretty.

Home

Chapter Summary

Adora and Catra learn a little more about what happened to Mara, and finally get to bring their little kitten home for the first time.

Chapter Notes

TW for mentions of past child abuse!!

There were a lot of things that Adora missed about their little cottage in the Whispering Woods, from the space away from everyone else to the cricket chirps that helped lull her to sleep alongside the purrs of her fiance. She did have to admit though that it was nice to be back in the castle close to her friends again, despite the fact she was spending most of her time in the medical wing of the palace.

Like the last two days, Adora was currently sitting in a rocking chair Bow had brought for her, cradling Mara while Catra was off talking to doctors about the infant's condition. She'd managed to get Mara to nap by rocking gently and quietly humming to try and mimic the purring she was used to from Catra. She couldn't help but smile when Mara suddenly yawned, babbling softly before starting to knead against Adora's shirt, "You're adorable, little one.." She whispered, cradling her closer and pressing a little kiss to their forehead, "I hope you know how much we love you, and will always protect you.."

Tears then threatened to well up in her eyes when Mara almost immediately began purring, her eyes opening to stare up curiously at the blonde. Giggling, Mara blew a raspberry before pressing her cheek against Adora's chest.

The cuddle session was interrupted a few moments later, however, when *Bow* of all people walked into the room, a glare fixed on his face as he fought to not literally slam the door against the wall upon opening it, "Woah.. is everything okay, Bow..?"

The archer took a deep breath before shaking his head, "No."

"Care to enlighten me on what happened..?"

"Just… we got the test results back on what was causing Mara's eyes to stay closed…"

Adora's eyes widened, "Oh…?" She knew it couldn't be good based on her friend's reaction alone, "Does Catra know already..?"

Bow nodded, "She's currently uhm… taking her anger out with Glimmer outside on the sparring field.."

That made Adora tense, "Jeez… okay well, what was it?"

Taking another deep breath, Bow took a seat on the edge of the cot, "They found traces of- adhesive in the swabs they tested."

The rocking chair stilled as Adora stared at her friend in shock, the reality of what could have happened to Mara slowly sinking in and processing in her mind.

"...Adora?"

"Yes?"

"Are you okay..?"

"Mhm…why?"

"Because your eyes are glowing.."

"I'm okay, Bow…" Adora promised, taking a deep breath as she lifted Mara up and held her against her chest, one hand resting on her back and the other under her bottom. She closed her eyes and started to rock again. Mara's happy babbles and laughter was the only thing calming her down, but a few tears still ran down her cheeks.

Carefully, the archer stood again and approached Adora, "I'm just glad she's alright now, and no physical lasting effects seem to be there."

"Mhm… I just… whoever- abandoned her better hope I never meet them. That's all."

“They better hope *none* of us ever find out who they are.”

Nodding again, the blonde looked at the kitten, who only laughed and placed her hand against her cheek, drawing a smile out of Adora, “Hey sweetie…”

“Abab!” Mara exclaimed, purring as she nuzzled herself under Adora’s chin.

“Mhm? I’ve gotchu, little one don’t worry…”

“Adora!?”

The blonde and Bow looked up as Catra and Glimmer entered the room, both sweating, though the queen had a few new scratch marks, “Are you okay?”

“Better than I was…can I hold her?” Catra asked, calming more when their kitten was handed to her, “Are you okay, honey?”

“Mabap!” Mara replied, giggling as she curled up in the magicat’s arms.

"Yeah..?" Catra smiled slightly, looking in Mara's eyes for any signs of pain or injury. She was relieved to find none, the redness had

even disappeared.

"Cubbol!" Mara laughed, digging her claws into Catra's shirt in an attempt to cuddle up as close as she could.

"She's definitely gotten more vocal over the past few days," Glimmer smiled, "I bet you two are excited to bring her home for the first time."

"You have no idea.." Adora smiled, not taking her eyes away from her baby and fiance.

"Do you know when you'll be able to go home?"

"Althea told me this morning we could leave as early as tomorrow as long as she sleeps well tonight and nothing happens."

"That's great to hear, I know you both miss your cottage." Bow smiled, watching Mara try to climb up Catra's shirt to see over her shoulder.

"I know I do. No offense, Sparkles, but this castle hurts my eyes sometimes."

"I'm aware, Horde Scum." The queen laughed, sticking her tongue out at the magicat.

⚔

Catra and Adora couldn't keep the smiles off their faces as they made their way through the Whispering Woods towards their home, Mara looking around with wide eyes full of interest.

Adora was sitting on top of Swift Wind, Mara in her arms while Catra and Melog walked alongside them, "You know you didn't have to walk right?" Swifty asked, glancing at the magicat.

"I know, but I'm fine walking with Melog, Adora needs the rest, and I want Mara to have plenty of space to look around."

"I'm terrified to know how protective you'll be when I actually start showing." Adora teased, cradling Mara closer to her chest.

"I'm just cautious. You're a reckless person."

"Hey!" Now pouting, the blonde turned her attention to their daughter, who was focused on the trees above her.

"You know I'm right, babe." Catra chuckled, "I'll give you credit though, you aren't nearly as bad as you used to be."

"Thank you.." Adora huffed, blushing.

"Alright lovebirds, we're home!" Swift Wind announced, interrupting the couple as they finally broke through into the clearing that held their cottage.

"Welcome home, little one," Adora smiled, cradling Mara in one hand, before taking Catra's with the other to carefully slide off Swift Wind onto her feet.

"Luckily we have a crib already. We just need to move it into our room for the time being." Catra hummed, wrapping an arm around her lover's waist as they made their way onto the porch where Melog was already waiting.

"I think Melog missed home more than we did." Adora laughed, watching the feline sprint inside the moment Catra pushed open the door.

"Clearly," The brunette smiled, making her way inside after Adora before they headed down the hallway into their bedroom, where Melog had already flopped over and curled up in the center of the bed, "Do you think you can help me move the crib?"

"Sure. Melog, can you protect Mara for us?"

Meowing, Melog began to purr as the infant was placed against them, sitting up against their side.

"Aweee…" The couple cooed, watching as Mara clapped and began purring as well.

"We'll be right back, little one okay? We gotta get your crib in here." Catra explained, leaning down and kissing their forehead before the two left the room to cross into the nursery, "Alright you get the far end and I'll take this side so you don't have to walk backwards." She hummed, smirking slightly when she noticed Adora roll her eyes.

"My knight and shining armor." Adora replied sarcastically.

"I know, thanks for noticing," Catra smirked, giggling as they carefully lifted and began moving the crib across the hall.

When they got into the room, Mara immediately began to whimper and reach for them, “Just a second little one, we aren’t going anywhere, I promise.”

Once they set the crib down, the couple sat on either side of Mara and watched her look around, now calmer. Adora laid back,

smiling up at Melog, "I don't know about you guys, but I'm ready for a nap."

“Did moving the crib tire you out, princess?” Catra asked, a growing smirk on her face.

“No!” Adora huffed, hugging Mara close to her in defense. The kitten laughed and cuddled up, enjoying the attention.

“Mhmm. Well, you stay here and watch Mara then, I’m gonna go get her a bottle warmed up.”

Adora nodded and watched as her fiance left the room. Catra was far less than surprised when she returned to Adora passed out on the bed with a waiting Mara playing with the blankets.

Pictures of the Past

Chapter Summary

Catra learns about her past, and the couple visits Madame Razz to learn about their daughter.

Chapter Notes

TW// Mentions of past child abuse

Adora groaned softly as she tiptoed her way down the hall to the kitchen. It was just past three am, and she'd woken up with a dire need for some ice cream. Stupid cravings.

With a tiny smile, she made her way to the freezer and pulled out a pint of strawberry ice cream, sitting at the counter and eating it straight out of the carton with a spoon from one of the island drawers. It was a perk of having a fiance who was severely lactose intolerant; they had to get separate ice cream containers, and Adora got to keep hers to herself.

After eating half the pint, she placed the spoon in the sink and slipped the treat back in the freezer before heading back to the bedroom. Unfortunately, with it being so late and dark, she miscalculated and stubbed her toe against the dresser corner upon entering, drawing a curse from her lips and causing a couple of books to topple off to the floor.

Mara reacted immediately with a scream, crying out in fear that sent Adora into a panic and a half conscious Catra stumbling off the bed in a half attempted fighting position.

"Shh, shh sweetie, it's okay!" Adora assured, hurrying to the crib after turning the lights on.

"Whathappened-?" Catra slurred, rubbing her eyes.

"I'm sorry, I knocked a book or something over and scared Mara. Shh, baby.." Carefully, Adora lifted the infant into her arms, cradling her close. She was relieved that Mara quickly calmed down, a vice grip as tight as a baby could manage taking hold of her shirt, "There you go, little one.. It's okay.. " Her heart broke when she realized that while calmer, Mara was still trembling and looking around in fear.

Now more awake, Catra guided Adora to sit on the bed before joining her, not surprised when Melog began sniffing Mara to check on her, "She's okay, Melog, give her some space."

Meowing, the feline retreated to Catra's side, still staring at the infant.

"It's okay, sweetheart… we've gotchu.." Adora whispered, kissing her forehead and smiling down at Mara, who had calmed significantly more.

Whimpering, Mara buried her face into Adora's chest, her claws still threatening to pierce her shirt.

"What were you doing up..?" Catra finally asked, caressing their daughter's tuft of mane.

"I got a craving for ice cream. I just ran into the dresser on the way back. I'm sorry.."

"Hey, it's alright. She's okay, we all are." Noticing Mara was no longer shaking, and had even begun purring slightly, Catra took a deep breath, "Maybe we should try to get back to bed?"

Nodding, Adora stood, and started to lower Mara back into the crib, only for them to squeal in protest and start shaking again.

"Oh, baby…" Adora felt tears welling up. She retracted back to the bed and laid back against her pillows, shielding Mara with her blanket.

"I'll get the main lights." Catra said, turning off the ceiling light, but leaving on the lamp on her side so they wouldn't be shrouded in the dark again. She curled up against Adora once she was done, "I know you said we may never know but… we really need to find out as much as we can about what happened to her, Adora. We need to know how to help her through moments like this.."

"I was thinking about that… I wanted to visit Razz again anyway about something else, but I think asking about Mara will also be insightful."

"What else..?"

"Right, I meant to show you the night we got back from Halfmoon but, you know. Can you go grab my satchel from the desk?"

Wordlessly, the brunette gave a nod before getting up and grabbing the requested item from their desk, before returning to bed. Adora cradled Mara in one hand and opened the satchel with the other, digging through it until she found what she was looking for, "Look what I found in the library," She hummed, passing the photo of the two magicat kings to her, "We were right about Halfmoon being a magicat kingdom, but the question is who the baby in the corner is."

"Hate to break it to you, princess, but unless we find the torn piece we may never know."

"That's the thing Catra. I studied it for a while and… those men look awfully familiar, don't you think?"

".. Not really?" Catra furrowed her eyebrows, confused.

"Well, I know there aren't a lot of photos to go off of, but I only know one magicat with heterochromia like they both do. I guess I can't say the same for the brown hair now, but you know what I'm trying to say."

Catra remained silent, staring at the old picture in her hand for a moment before scoffing out a short laugh, "You're not seriously suggesting that we're looking at my parents right now that- that I'm a princess- *the* princess of a desolate, forgotten kingdom, are you?" She looked up at the blonde, a mix of fear and faux amusement in her eyes.

"I know it's a lot, love, but that photo isn't the only evidence. When I was training with Light Hope, when she first started talking about balancing the planet, she showed me this- this hologram. It was of all the princesses, and I recognized every single one of them as my friends or their parents, but one of them was a magicat that looked just like you. On top of all that, the weird symbol we saw on all those tapestries.. I finally realized why we recognized it. It was the same shape as the old headpiece you used to wear. Is it really so far-fetched to believe that was actually your crown? I mean it was the only thing I found with you." Adora realized that her lover was silent, staring at the photo with unshed tears brimming her eyes, "... I'm sorry, it's late and this is so much-"

"-No, no.. It's fine. I just- shi- stars.." She cleared her throat, tearing her eyes away long enough to make sure Mara was asleep, and she was thankfully, "It makes sense, all of it, I just… if it is true I just wish I knew why my d-dads.. left me."

"Maybe they didn't. We still don't know how Halfmoon fell. I think it would be worth looking into eventually, if you want. Maybe they left something behind for you we haven't found yet."

"Maybe.. It's a nice thought, but I just- I wanna focus on Mara first. We have all the time in the world to visit Halfmoon again later."

"That's understandable, and I agree. Maybe we'll find things out while learning about Mara. I'm still completely stumped as to how she wound up there alone in a… in the way she did."

"Yeah…" Catra sighed, a growl dying in her throat, "How about we get some sleep, and we'll go see Razz tomorrow, like you said? She deserves to meet her either way."

"Of course. Melog, can you sleep on the other side of me for Mara tonight? She's clearly not going anywhere.."

Meowing with a trill, Melog gave Catra a lick on the cheek before hopping over to the other side of the bed and laying down next to Adora, protecting the baby from falling off the bed if she somehow wiggled out of Adora's arms.

"Goodnight, dummy. I love you.." Catra whispered, kissing Adora's cheek before laying back down.

"I love you too.." Adora hummed, getting comfortable and closing her eyes just as Catra finally turned off the lamp.

⚔

Mara's happy babbles kept a smile on the couple's faces as they strolled down the path to Madame Razz's home, "Everything must look so pretty huh, little one?" Catra chuckled, purring when she was given a reply of laughter and tiny claps of approval.

"At least she's entertained," Adora chuckled, smiling gratefully towards her fiance when she moved a branch out of the way so she could step into the clearing.

"Adora!" Razz exclaimed the second she looked up and saw her. She immediately dropped her broom and hobbled over, "Catra! Oh, you've brought little Mara. It's about time!"

"You know about- nevermind," Catra shook her head, "Yeah, we did, we were hoping you might..know things about her?"

"Ahh, yes, her traumatic experiences I'm sure." Razz frowned, placing a gentle hand on Mara's cheek. The infant squealed with joy and hugged her hand.

Adora was already tearing up, "Do you know what happened to our little girl..?"

Another sigh escaped Razz, "Perhaps we should all sit down with some tea."

⚔

Catra and Adora sat on the couch while Razz rested in her rocking chair, Mara propped up against Melog on the floor, playing with a few stuffed animals they'd brought with them.

"What do you know already?" Razz asked as a leading question.

"We know she was left in a crate in an abandoned campsite and that she had a…adhesive in her eyes.." Catra stumbled over her words, squeezing Adora's hand when it was offered.

"She also gets really scared of yelling or sudden noises." Adora added, "But I'm guessing most babies would be."

"Yes… Well I hate to tell you that that campsite wasn't technically abandoned, but be glad you found her before the owners returned." Razz had an angry frown fixed on her face, an expression almost foreign to Adora, she almost always saw the old woman smiling, and yes frowning on occasion, but never angry,

"They were from the Horde, and you probably know who they are," She started, rocking gently in her chair, never taking her eyes from Mara playing happily in the floor, "Mara here was one of the only native magicats left from Halfmoon, besides her mother and, well you of course, dearie," Razz glanced towards Catra, who tensed slightly, but nodded, "But you already knew that. Anyway, her mother was trying to survive in that wasteland, when some ex soldiers showed up and attacked. We all can guess what happened to the mother, but as for Mara here…"

Adora finally looked away from Mara, "What did they do..?"

"They decided instead of leaving her to the same fate as her mother, they would fetch the best price for her, and were doing things to ensure she wasn't..a problem."

Catra felt bile rising up in her throat. She was *going* to find these monsters, but she wasn't sure if she could take hearing who did all of this right now without blowing up. Still, the question flew from her mouth before she could stop it, " *Who* ?"

"I don't think it's a good time to tell you, dearie-"

"I said WHO?!" Catra snapped, her claws extending to full length.

"Catra, calm down!" Adora exclaimed, grabbing her wrists and turning her to face her, "Deep breaths…"

Catra gasped, tearing up and throwing her arms around the blonde, "I.. I'm sorry..!"

"It's alright, dearie, I understand." Razz offered a smile, "I will tell you eventually, but for now I think you should focus on keepingMara happy and..learning more of your own heritage."

Nodding, Catra buried her face in Adora's shoulder once the blonde stood, "Do you know anything about my dads..?"

"I believe I met them once, but it was before you were born. I can tell you they loved you very much, and whatever happened that separated you was not their decision."

"Thank you.." Catra sniffed, finally standing and looking down at Mara, who was still babbling happily at her stuffed bear and bunny.

"Thank you for everything, Razz, we should get home soon, it's about time for Mara to nap."

"Of course. Make sure you visit often!"

"We will." Adora promised, giving the old woman a hug before the small family soon departed the hut.

⚔

"I think we should go back to Halfmoon soon…"

"Really?" Adora smiled, looking up from her parenting book. Catra was currently cradling a sleeping Mara next to her, the couple having laid down an hour ago.

"Yeah… I wanna see what else we can find about me or my.. dads. Maybe we can figure out if they're still alive or if not.. what happened."

"That sounds like a great idea. I'm sure Bow and Glimmer would babysit Mara for us."

"Once she's comfortable with them of course."

"Of course." Putting her book down, Adora snuggled up to her fiance, "I love you, Catra.."

"I love you too, Adora, with all my heart."

Words & Letters

Chapter Summary

> Catra, Adora, and Entrapta finally take another trip to Halfmoon, where they find out more about Catra's past. Turns out they aren't alone on the island though...

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

“Come on, little one you got this!” Catra encouraged, holding her arms out as Mara slowly waddled towards her. Adora was sitting on the floor behind her for extra support, just in case.

Ever since they visited Razz three months ago, the couple had devoted all of their time to Mara, making sure she was happy and developing the best she could. Doing so stalled things like their mission to Halfmoon and left little time for things outside of medical appointments, but it was worth it to see her happy.

“Cabbah!” Mara laughed, stumbling slightly over her little tail as she made her way into Catra’s waiting arms.

“Good job, Mara!” Catra praised, lifting her up and cradling her, “You did so amazing, little one,” She smiled, kissing her nose and drawing little giggles from the kitten.

“omma!”

Adora gasped, eyes sparkling, “Did she-”

Ears perking up, Catra stared down at Mara, “What was that?”

“omma!” She repeated, grabbing at her shirt and cuddling in close, “Mm..Momma!”

Tears welled up in both women’s eyes, “Awee..!” Adora put her hands over her mouth, a wide smile on her face. Catra on the other hand, had her ears pinned and tears running down her face, but she was smiling as well.

“Y-Yeah.. I’m momma, sweetie..” Catra whispered, nuzzling her cheek with a small trill.

Adora carefully scooted herself over to be at Catra’s side, wrapping her arms around her shoulders. She knew how special this moment was for the magicat, and she couldn’t be happier for her.

Catra smiled, kissing her fiance’s cheek, “I love you both, so much…”

“We love you too, Catra.” Adora giggled, resting her head on her shoulder, “Think it’s time we move back to the bed..? My back hurts..”

“Sure thing, dummy.” Catra snorted, standing and placing Mara in

her crib before carefully helping Adora to her feet, "Are you okay?"

"Mhm…" Adora gripped onto her partner's hands, letting her guide her to recline back in the bed.

"I love you.." Catra hummed, kissing Adora's nose, smirking at the little whine it drew from her fiance.

"I love you too… she's progressing so well." Adora hummed, glancing over at the kitten, who was watching them with a wagging tail and smile.

"She is… I almost can't believe it, all things considered. But I'm so proud of her."

"Momma!"

"Okay, okay, I'm sorry!" Catra laughed, reaching over and lifting Mara into her arms, "Better?"

"Momma." Mara giggled, nuzzling into her shirt.

"Maybe soon I'll get to hear 'mommy'," Adora joked, ruffling Mara's hair, earning a giggle in return, "By the way, I was thinking

now might be a good time to actually get back on track to visiting Halfmoon."

"Now?" Catra frowned, "Adora.. Are you sure? I get Mara is more comfortable around Bow and Glimmer now, but you're six months in now.."

"I can handle an afternoon or two, Catra. Besides, most of it will be spent digging through that old library. The longer we wait.. I mean what if your dads are still alive?"

"I highly doubt that, Adora.." Absentmindedly, the brunette began gently rubbing the kit's back, purring softly to keep her calm, "I'd be… extremely surprised and.. We'll be lucky to find out what happened to them at all." She looked down at Mara for a moment before sighing, "You're right though, it will probably be just digging through books and files so.. a day or so won't hurt."

Adora nodded, "Well, I have high hopes. I'm gonna call Glimmer to see when she can babysit."

⚔

"...and make sure you check the list so know when to feed her and when to give her their vitamins-!"

"Would you just go? We've got this, Catra!" Glimmer urged, pushing Catra towards Darla, where Adora and Entrapta were waiting, "Plus we have Melog to help too. Everything will be fine!"

"Yeah but- sometimes she can be a little tricky to figure out!" Catra was in panic mode, her eyes still looking back at Mara, who was cradled in Bow's arms, playing with a stuffed bunny, "M-Maybe we should wait another day-"

"-Catra!" Glimmer groaned, grabbing her friend by the shoulders and forcing them to make eye contact, "Mara will be *fine* . I promise! We have Melog, Bow, my dad, me, and all of her doctors at literal beck and call. She's safe, okay? Do I even need to mention the *three page* list you left?"

Though her tail continued to wag anxiously, Catra calmed, nodding, "Okay… okay…" She whispered, taking deep breaths and allowing Glimmer to guide her to the ship.

"Besides, if *Adora* is calm about this, you should be too."

"Oh trust me, I'm extremely nervous," Adora admitted, a hand sliding down to her bump, "But with the baby, I'm doing my best not to cause any emotional distress on them if possible. That.. and recent meditation sessions with Perfuma have also helped." The blonde blushed, taking Catra's hand when she was close enough, "But, I trust you guys, and I know they'll be alright. Besides, we're only leaving for like- a day."

"Well, good luck you guys," Bow added as he finally approached, "Hopefully you'll find something useful."

"I have extremely high expectations!" Entrapta chimed in, clapping her hands together, "An entire kingdom laid to ruin years ago with only two known native peoples left as we know it?! Ahh! I can't wait!"

"Let's just go now before I change my mind." Catra sighed, kissing Mara on her forehead, and letting Adora do the same before the trio waved goodbye and boarded Darla once again.

⚔

"We will be arriving shortly!" Entrapta happily called to the couple, who were cuddled up together in the captain's chair, this time though, Adora in Catra's lap.

"Sounds good, thanks 'Trapta!" Catra called, before turning her attention back to her fiance, "Are you feeling okay?"

"Mhm!" Adora smiled, resting her head on Catra's shoulder, "They've been relatively calm today, thankfully. I've actually noticed that most of the kicking and such happens at night."

Nodding, the brunette gently rubbed the baby bump, a soft smile on her face, "I can't wait to meet them.."

"Stars, with how you protect Mara I can't even begin to imagine how you'll be with another kitten around."

"What can I say? I've never had something like this worth protecting before."

"Awe… baby…" Adora clung to her fiance, pressing little kisses to her cheek, "I love you…so much… I hope you know that.."

"Of course I do, princess," Catra whispered, placing her hand over Adora's and lightly caressing it with her thumb.

"Hm… you know you've always called me that, but technically.. I could do the same thing to you now.." Adora smirked, looking up at the magicat.

"What? No, no, no. That is my thing for you!" Catra's ears perked up, "No sudden kingdom appearing is changing that."

"Mmmm, finnnnne…" Adora pouted, letting it go for about ten seconds before an idea came to mind. She smirked once more and leaned up just enough to whisper in the magicat's ears, "What if I called you my prince instead..~?" She couldn't help but

revel in the way Catra's breath hitched and a blush covered her freckled face.

"Adora…!" She whined.

"Whaaat? Do you like it~?"

"We will return to this *later* , missy. You're lucky we're not alone.."

Giggling, Adora placed a kiss just under her ear before Entrapta approached.

"Sorry to ruin your uh.. moment, but we have landed." The scientist said, "And I made sure to land much closer to the old castle this time, so Adora wouldn't have to walk so far."

"Thanks, Entrapta." Adora smiled gratefully, and got to her feet as if the past five minutes hadn't just happened, "Coming, Catra?"

"Ghm- yes!" She groaned, standing and wrapping an arm around the blonde as the three made their way off the ship, the dilapidated castle just in front of them.

"Okay, so we are going to the library, Entrapta. Are you joining us?"

"I will, but I'd like to scout the rest of the area for any old tech or something. I'll meet you there!"

"You have your trackerpad just in case?" Catra asked, tucking her own into the satchel she'd brought.

"Of course I do! I'll see you guys soon!" With that, the scientist was in her own world, hurrying off to explore and gather as much information as possible.

"Well, guess it's just us now.." Adora teased, earning a small nip at her ear.

"You, hush. You suggested this, so stop distracting us."

Unable to stop the laughter that followed, Adora nodded and allowed herself to be led inside and back to the old library.

Along the way, they used the trackerpad to take a few photos of the old tapestries and map out the building for future reference. When they did finally make it to the library, Adora found a comfortable spot in the desk chair, beginning to go through the drawers while Catra looked around for anything else that might be useful.

"You know, I think the biggest question I have is how I wound up in the Frightzone." Catra asked, running her fingers along some books on a leaning shelf.

"If the Horde attacked, I'd guess they kidnapped you." Adora frowned, looking through a folder of notes from the war in one of the drawers.

"I mean- yeah, but then how was I in a box that you found me in? If that was the case I should have been brought in like the other kids.. I don't know. I know I'll probably never know." She made her way back to the middle of the room.

"Well, after we finish in here, maybe we should look for a bedroom or the throne room or something. Anywhere else where we could find something useful. You'd have been little so.. perhaps we could find a nursery?"

"Maybe. What do you have there?"

"Looks like some notes for defense plans." Adora hummed, thumbing through the papers, "I think they knew offense wasn't an option. I think this attack happened not long after the first Princess Alliance failed, so without any help, they could only hope to hide and fight them off."

"I still can't believe none of our friends knew about this. If their parents allianced with them, surely they'd know *something* ."

"We were all really young, Catra. Talking about the fall of a kingdom isn't something to talk with a kid about."

"I know, I know.." Catra huffed, her ears pinning momentarily until she felt Adora's arms wrap around her waist.

"Maybe we should go find the throne room or something?" She suggested, slipping the folder into Catra's satchel.

"Yeah, sounds like a good idea."

⚔

As the couple made their way down the hall, they were eventually met with a throne room. Two thrones sat atop a platform on one end, and a torn rug ran down the room leading to it. More destroyed tapestries lined the walls between the large open windows. It wasn't until they were close enough to the thrones that they noticed a folded paper sitting on one of them.

"Well? What is it?" Adora asked, prompting her partner to reach forward and take it.

Biting her lip, and her ears pinning with nerves, Catra carefully unfolded the yellowed and slightly torn page, gasping when a

letter addressed to *her* was revealed.

Dear C'yra (Catra),

We aren't sure if your name or nickname has followed you, but either way we pray you know that this letter belongs to you.

Things were never supposed to turn out like this. You were supposed to grow up and lead your people like the beautiful, powerful princess you were born to be. We knew the day you were born you would be just as kind as Cyrus and as stubborn as me.

When the Horde attacked Halfmoon, we were left in the worst position as fathers and kings. We had to protect our kingdom, defending as best as we could, but in doing so, neglected to make sure you were safe. You wandered into the wrong arms and…

We can only look to the stars and hope you are still safe. We would give anything to mend our mistakes and have you in our arms once again. We hope you never forget just how much we love you, and will always love you. You were all we ever wished for.

Whether we are still here is up for debate. After we lost both the battle and you.. We did everything we could to find you, but the Frightzone was too greatly guarded, and we have lost so many people…

If you find this, we are fleeing to the Crimson Waste to hide with our remaining people from the Horde. May you be safe.

All Daddy and Papa's Love,

King Cyrus & Ezekiel

Tears ran down both women's faces. Catra gasped, sobbing as she covered her mouth with a hand.

"There… there's a chance! They could very well still be alive, Catra." Adora smiled, placing a hand on her cheek.

"I h-hope so.. but it's so relieving to know..they loved me.."

"Love, Catra. They *love* you, so much, just like I do. We're going to find them, I promise."

"You can't promise that.."

"Well… I can promise we'll do everything we can."

"Thanks, princess.." Catra smiled, wiping her eyes before hugging Adora, the two embracing gently for a few moments of comfortable silence.

When they pulled apart, Catra carefully folded the note and slipped it into her satchel, "Think we'll find anything else this informative..?" She asked with a small laugh as she wiped her eyes.

"Not sure, *C'yra* ." Adora smirked, laughing when she was rewarded with a playful swat to her shoulder.

"Clearly I was named after my dad, thank you."

"I know, I know, I'm teasing. Seriously though, I doubt we'll find anything this big, but Entrapta is gonna be busy for a while so, maybe we should just look around and finish mapping the place out? Maybe find your old room."

"Sure, shall we then?"

Adora took a few steps before pausing, "Ah… you know what, I'll meet you. Lunch has hit and I really need the bathroom."

"Want me to walk you?"

"Nah, the ship is just outside, I'll be right back."

Nodding, Catra kissed Adora gently before stepping back, "I love you, be careful."

"Love you too." Adora smiled, turning around and making her way back to the ship.

Sighing, Catra strolled down towards the hall they came from, looking around and slowly becoming lost in thought.

She could have grown up in these very walls, surrounded by her own people and not tormented and abused for twenty years of her life. But.. then would she have ever met Adora? Maybe, but she could have been so much different… Shadow Weaver very well could have succeeded in turning her into a heartless Force Captain that destroyed Etheria. Adora had told her so many times how much she helped her remember that there was more than conquering and rising the ranks of the Horde.

Still… a small part of her wished she had been raised by her dads, and wondered what could have been, the life she could have had, despite knowing she would never be truly happy without Adora at her side.

She sighed again when she passed a tapestry that was mostly intact. Carefully, she ran her fingers over the fabric, the shape of her headpi- *crown* , sewn in the middle of it. Maybe she should

return to Prime's ship one day and try to recover it. It was the only physical thing from her parents really. It would be well worth it, especially if her dads weren't…

Shaking her head out of *that* thought, she looked up and behind her, realizing it had been a few minutes longer than she would like for Adora to be gone.

Just as she turned to head back, a tone she always feared from her fiance echoed through the broken walls.

"CATRA!"

"Adora?!" Catra gasped, racing on all fours back towards the ship.

"CATR-"

"Adora? Adora?! Ad-" Catra gasped as she made it outside, skidding to a halt.

"Nice to see you again, Force Captain."

Chapter End Notes

Is now a really bad time to tell you that Adora hasn't used She-Ra since she found out she was pregnant? She's too afraid of what the transformation will do to her pregnancy...

Old Habits Die Hard

Chapter Summary

Catra and Adora finally meet the monsters responsible for hurting their daughter, but in the process learn that old evils are still around.

Chapter Notes

Trigger Warnings// A quick mention of blood

A couple of OG characters I made appear in this chapter, so here is a little information about them!

Ivone:
- Male (he/him)
- 27
- Force Captain (during war)
- Never liked Catra because of how she climbed the ranks; despises her after her betrayal to Prime/the Horde

Lynx:
- Non-binary (they/them)
- 25
- Solider (during war)
- Doesn't know Catra well, is really only there because they have a massive crush on Ivone

"Nice to see you again, Force Captain."

"Ivone…" Catra snarled, her claws extending to their full length, "You have exactly *ten seconds* to let her go."

Adora gasped as she was roughly pulled against her captor, one hand covering her mouth while the other pinned her arms behind her. Ivone's lackey, Lynx, was aiming a knife directly at her. Tears ran down her face as she struggled against Ivone.

"Or what? You wouldn't do anything to put Adora in danger. Besides, I heard you have a little something of mine."

"What could I *possibly* -" Catra's eyes shrunk to slits when she realized what he meant, " *You* … YOU'RE the one who hurt Mara?!"

"That's what you're calling the brat?" He chuckled, "Stupid name, but whatever. Well, if you want your fiance and unborn bastard back, I'd suggest bringing it back to me."

"You're fucking insane!" Catra growled, starting to advance to attack, only for Lynx to hold up a hand.

"I wouldn't do that if I were you." They said, "Wouldn't want anything to happen to these two would you?" They emphasized their point by placing the tip of the blade to Adora's baby bump, drawing a muffled scream from the blonde, who'd tensed and was trembling violently.

Catra froze immediately, fear suddenly trampling her rage, "Don't.. Don't you *dare* …!"

"You want these two? Bring me the stupid brat. It's not even yours, there's no reason for you to care for it anyway."

"She is my daughter now you *sick* bastard. T-that's all that matters!" Tears ran down Catra's face, "There's a million ways to make money, y-you don't need some innocent baby for that!"

"I can't decide if you're too stupid to understand what choice you're making, or if you care more for that thing than you do your own fiance." Ivone chuckled, pushing Adora forward just enough for a little trickle of blood to run down her abdomen and stain her shirt.

Adora's eyes widened, screaming much louder this time, both in pain and fear. Though muffled, it was clear she was begging them not to hurt her baby.

"STOP!" Catra screamed, shaking with rage and fear. She wasn't sure what to do, fearing the absolute worst, until magic suddenly surrounded them both, freezing them in place, "Wha-"

"I think YOU two are incredibly stupid for daring to show your faces!" Glimmer shouted, approaching and grabbing Lynx and forcing her, and by association the knife, away from Adora and to the ground, before shoving Ivone away as well, and catching Adora before she collapsed, gasping and crying, "Shh, shh.. It's okay.." She whispered, passing her to Catra when she rushed over.

"G-Glimmer? How- what-"

"-I saw what was going on and called her." Entrapta explained, approaching moments later.

"...T-thank you.. Stars, thank you so much.." Catra managed, holding Adora close, one hand around her waist and the other over her stomach, despite the fact She-Ra's magic had already healed it, "I'd hug you right now if I could…"

"That's alright, I'm just glad to help! No physical affection required!" Entrapta smiled, her pigtail patting the magicat on the head.

"C-Can we g-g-go home..?" Adora gasped, still trembling in her lover's arms.

"Of course, princess. We're going." Catra promised, kissing the top of her head.

"I'm gonna teleport you two to the infirmary, then come back to help Entrapta with these dumbasses." Glimmer explained after using her magic to bind the two perpetrators together.

"Thanks, Sparkles.." Catra smiled, holding Adora protectively as they were returned to Brightmoon in the blink of an eye.

⚔

Catra cringed as Adora vomited once again into the bucket in front of her. After rushing her to the palace infirmary and confirming that both she and the baby were stable, the stress and trauma of the situation had come crashing down, on Adora especially.

Unable to do anything except hold her partner and keep her hair out of the way, Catra simply looked away whenever another wave of nausea washed over Adora.

The blonde whimpered after she finished, leaning back against Catra and handing the bucket to Sage, who was patiently waiting at the bedside.

"Are you sure you're not going to throw up again, princess?"

"Mhm.. I'm sure…" Adora whined, gripping onto Catra's hands and closing her eyes.

Nodding, Sage walked off to empty and clean the bucket after leaving a clean one, just in case.

"How are you doing, princess?" Catra whispered, gently running her fingers through her hair.

"I'm fine.. just- just.. I'm in shock, and I'm scared, and I thought…"

"You know I will always protect you right..?"

"Of course I do.." Adora sniffed, nuzzling her face into Catra's shoulder, "I'm glad we caught who hurt her.."

"Me too.. They deserved that justice, even if they don't understand it yet."

".. Can I see her please..?"

"I can go find Bow-"

"No!" Adora suddenly went into panic mode, a vice grip on Catra's arms.

"Whoa, baby I'm not-"

"-Stay! Please!" She gasped, tears running down her face.

"Hey, hey..!" Catra cupped her fiance's face, pressing a kiss to her nose, "I've gotchu, don't worry. I'm not going anywhere. You're safe, I promise."

"Promise..?"

Catra couldn't help but chuckle softly, "I promise."

"Any more vomiting?" Sage asked once she returned.

"No, but actually I'm glad you're here. Can you go find Bow and ask him to bring Mara to us please?"

"Of course," The nurse smiled before leaving the infirmary.

Catra looked down at Adora, who was still clinging to her, shaking ever so slightly, "It's okay, baby… I'm right here…" She whispered, rubbing her baby bump gently.

"I know…" Adora sniffed, squeezing her hand, "I- I'm sorry-"

"-Hey hey," Catra interrupted, "Do not go there, okay? You're pregnant, over halfway through pregnancy I might add, and you just went through something *terrifying* . You have every right to be scared and upset right now. Your hormones are already wack as it is, this didn't help."

Nodding, Adora took a deep breath, giving her partner a kiss on the cheek just as the door swung open, "Special delivery!" Bow exclaimed, carrying a laughing, babbling Mara over to her mother's, placing her in Adora's lap.

"Hey sweetie.." Adora smiled, wrapping her arms around the kitten, who clung happily to her, babbling, "Did you have a good time with Uncle Bow..?"

"Ucle Bam!" Mara repeated, laughing when the uncle in question gasped and teared up, cooing over her.

"Good job, little one, you broke him." Catra snickered.

"Soooo… cUte!"

"Calm down, Uncle Bam." Catra teased, snickering until they were interrupted by Glimmer teleporting into the room, "Bow? Catra? Oh! Perfect, I need you both like now."

"Why?"

"Dad and I are… interrogating them and.. You need to hear this!"

Catra started to move when Adora whimpering and grasping her hand stopped her, "Baby, I promise I'll be right back. Nothing can hurt you here, okay? Just stay here with Mara." She promised, cupping her fiance's cheek.

"O-Okay.." Adora slowly nodded.

"Momma!" Mara called out, holding her little hands out towards her.

"Stay with mommy and play okay?" Catra smiled, kissing Mara's forehead after giving Adora a quick peck on the lips.

"Momm…y, mommy!" Mara giggled, hugging Adora now, and sending the blonde into full on tears, but at least she was smiling now.

"She's learning so fast..!" Bow gasped, his eyes still sparkling from the cuteness.

"Yes she is, but you two need to hear this. We'll be right back Adora!" Glimmer promised before grabbing her partner and advisor and teleporting from the infirmary.

⚔

Catra groaned as she steadied herself, "I still don't think I'll ever get used to that…" She huffed, before looking towards the prison cell Ivone and Lynx were being held in for interrogation. Micah had already cast the truth spell, and had been waiting for them to arrive, "So, what did these bastards have to say for themselves?"

"I think I'll just repeat my question and let Ivone repeat himself." Glimmer glared, crossing her arms, "So, tell me again why you kidnapped Mara and tortured her for money?"

The defeated ex-force captain signed, leaning against the bars, "Like I said, Lynx and I were scavenging that island for anything we could find, and we found Shadow Weaver with this kitten thing-"

" *Shadow Weaver* ?!" Bow and Catra gasped, eyes widening.

"That's not possible! She's- she's dead! I-I *watched* her die!" Catra was already shaking. She stomped up to the bars and grabbed Ivone by the collar of his shirt, "Stop lying and tell me the real reason you tried to kill my daughter!"

"Catra!" Micah gently placed his hands on the brunette's shoulder and moving her away from the bars, "My spell *ensures* that he's

telling the truth. I don't know- *how* she's.. but she is."

"N-No..! She can't be she.. she sacrificed herself so me and Adora could… she said…" Tears ran down Catra's face. She couldn't believe this. Of *course* Shadow Weaver wouldn't sacrifice herself for them. Why would she? She didn't fucking care! All she wanted was power! Her hands were shaking now, her tail spiked with anxiety. Though she flinched when Bow wrapped his arms around her, she slowly followed him in taking a few deep breaths. She leaned against him before looking back at the prisoners, "Why did s-she have Mara..?"

"She said something about the Halfmoon runestone, and trying to activate it so she could draw its power and heal herself or something," Lynx explained, shrugging, "She thought maybe that kitten could do it."

"She told us that if we helped her that once done we could take the kid and earn whatever amount of money with it we could in the Wastes," Ivone added, "So she left to go find the stone and we stayed at the camp with the kid. Her mother showed up and…" Ivone sighed, "Anyway. We haven't seen her since."

"I need to get back to my fiance and babies." Catra said, before pulling out of her friend's arms and leaving the prison wing, and leaving the others to deal with the prisoners.

⚔

Despite everything she just heard, Catra couldn't help but smile when she walked back into the infirmary. Adora was propped up against a few pillows, holding Mara in her lap and watching her play with a couple of her stuffed animals. Fuck Shadow Weaver. That could be dealt with later, "Hey, Adora…"

"Hey, what was so urgent..?" Adora asked, looking up as the magicat approached.

"It's… Don't worry about it right now, okay?"

"Catra…" Adora frowned.

"Trust me, it's not something you need to worry about right now, alright?" Catra sighed, running her fingers through Adora's hair, "If it was, I promise I would tell you. But with everything else, it can wait."

"Okay…" Adora bummed, "Well, the doctors cleared me to go to our old room once you got back. Wanna go now?"

"Stars, *yes* . I'm so exhausted.." Carefully, she helped Adora up once she cradled Mara to her chest, and the small family made their way down the hall to their suite, taking less than an hour for all of them to fall asleep.

⚔

"Bahh…block!" Mara shouted, clapping when Adora smiled and praised her, placing the three blocks in front of her.

"Good job baby!" She smiled, watching as she started trying to stack them on the bed, but failing with the lumpy blankets as her surface. Of course, her attention moved within moments, and she was suddenly intrigued by Adora's baby bump.

"I think she's interested in her little sibling." Catra hummed.

Adora chuckled as she watched Mara poke her belly, "Yeah, you have a little sibling in there. I bet they can't wait to meet you!"

"Baby..?" Mara asked, looking up at her mothers, who nodded.

"Are you happy about that?" Catra asked. Adora's baby bump was getting bigger, so it was a little easier to somewhat explain where the alleged new sibling was.

"Yah!" Mara clapped, before hugging Adora's bump, making the couple gasp in awe. Catra immediately snapped a photo (or three) on her trackerpad.

"Hey guys! We wanted to- awe!" Glimmer gasped when she opened the door to the cutest sight on Etheria.

"OH My gOsH!" Bow squealed, "This is precious!"

Mara was quick to hiss and glare at her aunt and uncle before they could get too close, "My sibbing!"

"Sweetie, we would never hurt your sibling. We've been protecting Adora from her own left feet since we found out about them."

"Hey!"

Mara still refused to budge, much to everyone's amusement.

"That's a good sign she'll always protect her little sibling at least." Glimmer laughed, taking a seat next to Catra, Bow doing the same so Mara had plenty of space.

"So, have you two planned this whole Crimson Waste trip yet?" Bow asked.

"We wanted to go as soon as possible but.. with Adora being so heavily pregnant now and.. you know, it's the *Waste* , so it'll

probably be a while unfortunately.." Catra sighed, placing her trackerpad on the nightstand.

"We thought you'd say that." Glimmer hummed, kicking her feet slightly, "So Bow and I thought we could go look for them for you!"

"What?" Catra and Adora asked at the same time.

"Why not? We have the photo, and the easier mobility. We can teleport to and from as needed, and it's the safest option for Adora!"

"I mean..okay fair enough. But you don't have to do that…"

"We want to, Catra." Bow promised, placing a hand on her knee, "Besides, they deserve to come home and you deserve to meet your dads."

Slowly, a smile formed on Catra's face, "Mm.." After seeing the warm smile on Adora's face, she finally caved, "Okay fine! But you have to keep us updated."

"You know we will." Glimmer promised, leaning over and hugging her friend.

"Mara, careful!" Adora suddenly exclaimed, laughing as the kitten tried to climb onto Adora's baby bump. Catra quickly scooped the little bundle up into her arms.

"Now we can't climb our little sibling, sweetie."

"Sibbing!" Mara squealed, squirming and reaching out for Adora's bump.

"I'll set you down, but promise you won't climb mommy anymore okay?"

"Sibbing, mommy!"

"..I'll take that as a yes." Catra chuckled, setting her down between them.

Adora watched as Mara cuddled up to her side, keeping one of her little hands against her bump, "You're so sweet, little one.." She whispered, gently playing with the tuft of hair behind her ear.

"Alright, we'll leave you guys to be with Mara, we're gonna head to the Waste tomorrow." Bow finally said, both embracing their friends before finally leaving the bedroom.

"How long should we stay here before going home?" Adora asked after a few moments, looking to Catra.

"Well… if they find my dads, we're gonna wanna be here, and you wanted to give birth here so.. I guess for now.. we stay in Brightmoon. I'll get us some stuff from the house tomorrow. We know the woods will keep it safe and hidden for us, but I'll ask Razz to check on it while we're gone when she's in the area anyway."

"Alright…" Adora knew it was the best route, but she still missed their home already. They'd spent the last few months there just to make sure their daughter knew it was home, and their own memories there kept her feeling quite attached.

"Hey…we can stop by sometimes while you're still able to, okay?"

"Thanks…" Adora smiled, blushing when she received a kiss on the cheek.

⚔

Catra awoke that night with a start, looking around with wide eyes until they landed on Adora sleeping peacefully at her side and Mara in her crib, also asleep. Running a clawed hand through her mane, she silently got out of bed and made her way onto the balcony, looking out over Brightmoon. So many things were running through her mind.

Shadow Weaver was alive, for starters. How, Catra had absolutely no idea. Sure, the witch had a lot of power, clearly, but it really seemed like she'd died when fighting that First One's monster. Maybe she thought she would too and somehow just.. didn't, and now she was back to her old habits of wanting power. Worse than that, apparently she had her own runestone somewhere in Halfmoon and she was trying to take it from her! Hadn't she done enough?! Sure, did Catra have any idea what kind of ancient power she might get from that old rock if any? No, but that didn't give her any right to steal it either!

Sighing, Catra sniffed and wiped her eyes. How was she supposed to break all this news to Adora? She was stressed and scared enough as it was of Ivone and Lynx, learning their abusive former.. guardian was still alive wasn't going to ease that. They'd both worked so hard the past few years to get past her and heal.

Groaning, she dug her claws into the railing, "Fuck…"

"Catra..?"

Breath hitching and tail spiking, Catra looked behind her as Adora sleepily walked onto the balcony, "Adora.. Why are you up?"

"I was missing you spooning me…" The blonde admitted, blushing as she stepped up next to the magicat, balancing herself with the railing, "Why are you so upset..?"

"Just…bad dream, I'm fine."

Adora stayed silent for a few minutes, before taking a deep breath, "Does this have to do with the interrogation today?"

"Mm… kinda."

"Love.. you can tell me what they told you, I'll be okay-"

"- I *know* you'll be okay, Adora, but you'll be stressed and I don't want to add to everything you're already carrying!" Catra snapped, tears running down her face. She gasped when she realized she'd just yelled, and recoiled from her fiance, "I- I'm sorry-"

"Baby.." Adora gently took her lover's hands and pulled her into a light embrace, "Clearly *you're* super stressed. I know my emotions are absolutely wild right now, but you don't need to carry whatever this is alone, especially when it affects us both."

Slowly, Catra relaxed into Adora's arms, closing her eyes momentarily, "Okay.. fine. Just- please know we're safe and this isn't something we have to deal with until we're ready."

"Okay..?"

"Shadow Weaver is alive."

Immediately tensing, Adora pulled back enough to look at Catra, wide eyed, "Wh-..How..?"

"I don't know either. Ivone said they were scavenging Halfmoon when they found her with Mara. Also I apparently have a runestone and she thought she could access it with her to use the power to heal herself or something. So I'm guessing she's trapped on that island now since Ivone and Lynx aren't there with their transport anymore and she's obviously weak."

"Wow.. I- wow…" The blonde shook her head, "Well, I'm glad she's trapped then, because I don't want her near our babies. Thank you for telling me."

That was definitely not the reaction Catra had expected, "Are you okay?"

"I'm… I'm scared, I won't lie, but I know she can't hurt us, and she's far away. So I can sleep with that in mind."

Catra nodded, "Alright… maybe we should get back to bed then, before Mara wakes up."

"Sounds good, I'm exhausted…"

"Alright, princess, I'll be the big spoon."

"Yay!" Adora smiled, grabbing her fiance's hand and excitedly leading her back to bed.

United

Chapter Summary

Safe in Brightmoon, Adora is getting used to relaxing with her fiance and daughter.

Bow and Glimmer find a lost family.

Chapter Notes

A slightly shorter chapter, but all fluff!!!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra was taking her time getting back to their suite. The last couple of days had been a literal rollercoaster of emotions when it came to Adora. One second she was super affectionate and cuddly, and the next she was pouty or annoyed. Mara seemed to be her neutral ground, but the kitten was currently asleep in her crib, so Catra was on her own.

She took a deep breath as she gripped the tray she was carrying, using her foot to push the door open, "Adora?" She called, quietly stepping into the room.

"Yeah..?" The blonde yawned, stretching slightly as she propped herself up against her pillows, "What's that..?" She hummed, seeing the tray in her partner's hands.

"I got you some tea." Catra smiled, setting the tray on Adora's nightstand before returning to her side of the bed, "How was your nap?"

"Good… thank you.." Adora yawned again before gingerly picking up the cup and sipping on the tea, "Any word from Glimmer or Bow?"

"Not yet. They've been gone for three days now."

"I thought they teleported home every night?"

"Yeah.. They must have found something. I sent Bow a message on the trackerpad before I got the tea. I'm sure he'll answer soon."

"Hopefully…" After setting the cup back down, it was only a few moments later that she gasped and placed her hands on her abdomen.

"Are they kicking again?" Catra asked, scooting closer to her to spoon her.

"Mhm.." Adora sighed, closing her eyes and resting her head on Catra's shoulder.

"They've gotten more active recently. They must have your energy." The brunette teased, kissing behind her ear.

Whining, Adora leaned against her, grabbing her hand, "They're gonna bruise my kidney."

"Awe, I'm sorry princess," Catra kissed the top of her head, holding her gently but protectively, "Are you still tired?"

"Yeah… I might take another nap now…"

"You do that, my love…" Catra whispered, caressing her hair gently. She hummed quietly until Adora was fast asleep in her arms. The blonde seemed to be taking a lot of naps lately, but Catra didn't mind. She deserved all the time in the world to relax.

Her trackerpad beeped a few minutes later.

⚔

Glimmer sighed as she continued to make her way through the Crimson Waste, Bow at her side, "I really hope we find something soon. This is getting exhausting to do everyday."

"I know, Glimmer. I'm sure we'll figure this out! I really hope we can bring Catra good news soon."

"Me too, I just hate the desert."

"I don't like it either. I don't know how anyone could live here."

"Yeah…" Glimmer wiped the sweat from her forehead. She smiled though when she caught sight of some trees and water (a lake?) ahead, "Oh hey, check that out!"

Bow smiled when he saw the area up ahead as well, "Maybe we'll find someone there."

The couple took a few moments to approach. There was a hill a few yards away from the pond, they discovered, and shared a look, "If there is a camp around here it's gotta be close. This is way too perfect of a spot." Glimmer glanced around, before noticing footprints heading towards the hill away from the water, "Hey Bow look at-" She gasped, feeling something sting the back of her neck. She faintly heard Bow calling her name before she lost consciousness.

⚔

When Glimmer came to, she heard the sound of conversation somewhere around her. She groaned, slowly opening her eyes and glancing around. She was on a cot, in what looked like a tent, "Huh..?"

Slowly, she got to her feet, and made her way out of the tent. Bow was sitting around a campfire, talking to- magicats?! Eye lighting up, Glimmer hurried over, smiling at her partner when he noticed her, "Hey.."

"Hey! Are you feeling okay?"

"Yeah, I'm fine.. What happened?"

"We apologize, Your Majesty." One of the magicats said, "We aren't used to having peaceful visitors, and we were unaware that the war had ended."

"That's alright. I.. haven't met many magicats in my life."

"I'm surprised you've met any. All those that remain are here in our hideout."

After exchanging a look with Bow, Glimmer took a deep breath, smiling, "You wouldn't happen to be King Cyrus would you..?"

The man looked stunned, "..That's my husband actually, but..how do you..?"

"Well…" Bow could hardly contain himself, "We're actually close friends with someone you know as.. Princess C'yra."

Ezekiel's breath hitched, eyes widening, "You.. you know.."

"Your daughter, yes," Glimmer smiled, her heart both simultaneously breaking and swelling with joy upon seeing tears run down the magicat's face, "We've always known her as Catra, though. She was.. actually one of the only reasons we were able to defeat Horde Prime."

Unable to fully process the news, Ezekiel held up a finger before hurrying off to one of the tents, presumably to get his husband.

Bow felt his trackerpad buzz, and pulled it out of his satchel, "Speaking of Catra.." He chuckled, opening the message.

Catra: Hey! Any updates? You guys have been gone for like- days.

Bow: Yeah! We got some great news!

Catra: Really? What did you find out?!

Bow: I'll tell you when we get back :)

Catra: Boooow!! 3:<

Bow: <3

"You're awful." Glimmer giggled, resting her head on his shoulder.

"Well, I wanna surprise her! We know she won't expect us to actually find them by now. So it'll be even better if she thinks we just found a clue or something until they see each other."

"Oh, I know. I'm actually trying not to cry thinking about it," The queen had to blink a few times as she spoke, "I struggled for so many years after losing my dad, I can't imagine having never met him."

"Yeah, I couldn't imagine. I'm really happy that we get to help unite her family though."

"After this, we can hopefully start to restore Halfmoon, and of course, deal with Shadow Weaver." Glimmer groaned, "I can't believe she's still alive."

"Yeah, and proving she still hasn't really changed." Bow signed, "Adora and Catra at least had in mind she'd.. kinda changed when

they thought she'd done something good for once, and now… eesh."

Before Glimmer could reply, the magicat kings returned, both with teary eyes and anxious tails swaying behind them.

"You two have…you know our little girl?" Cyrus asked carefully, trying to hold his composure.

"We do. She lives in the Whispering Woods with her fiance, but she's currently staying in Brightmoon. She's actually my Royal Advisor." Glimmer confirmed, "And we'd be honored to reunite you with her, as well as assist in returning Halfmoon to its former glory."

"That is so generous, Your Majesty. We would be eternally grateful."

"Well then, we should prepare to head to Brightmoon! Will the rest of your camp be alright until then?"

"Of course. We just need to hold a meeting with them and then we can follow you to Brightmoon."

"Perfect. Lead the way!"

⚔

Adora had a smile on her face as she watched Catra gently combing Mara's short head of hair, humming to her.

"I think you're gonna put her to sleep." Adora giggled.

"I no seep mommy.." Mara retorted.

"Yeah?" Adora chuckled, "Your afternoon nap enough to power you through to bedtime?"

"Ya!" The kitten clapped, moving closer to be more between both her mothers once Catra finished with her mane.

"You're so strong, little one." Adora praised, lifting Mara into her arms and kissing her forehead, "I think mommy will make it until bedtime too."

"If you're feeling up to it, maybe we should take her for a walk around the castle." Catra suggested.

"Sure, sounds like fun." Adora nodded, holding Mara close as she allowed Catra to assist her in getting out of bed, "Did Bow ever message you back?"

"Yeah, he said he has some good news, but wouldn't elaborate."

"That's good.." Adora leaned on her fiance, smiling as she watched Mara look around, waving happily at all of the guards, "Could we go to the gardens? I haven't been there in a while."

"Of course, princess." Catra smiled, nuzzling her cheek as she guided the blonde towards the garden.

It was only around a five minute walk, and the couple had huge smiles on their faces as they watched Mara's eyes widen with fascination at all of the new sights and smells around her.

"What do you think, little one?" Adora asked, keeping some distance from the flowers in case Mara had any allergies they didn't know of yet.

"Pwetty!" She exclaimed.

"I think so too. When I was still feeling bad and couldn't walk, I spent lots of time out here with momma."

"You think that wheelchair will make a reappearance soon?" Catra teased.

"Absolutely not!" Adora huffed.

"It's still in our closet here in Brightmoon."

"No!" Whining, Adora pouted her lower lip and looked away, "I don't need it."

"Awe baby.." Catra giggled, and kissed her cheek, "Okay, if you don't want it, it can stay in the closet."

"Kitty!"

"Huh?" Catra turned, smiling when Melog approached, circling the couple a few times and meowing, "Hey buddy, what's up?" Catra asked, petting them behind their ears.

"I have something to show you! It's important!"

"Important huh? Well, last time you said that I found a baby." Catra chuckled, watching as Melog paused momentarily to reach up and lick Mara's nose, drawing a squeal and laugh from the kitten, "Alright, lead the way."

Adora simply followed where her fiance led her, hoping that Glimmer and Bow had been successful, assuming they were who Melog was leading them too.

⚔

"Are you ready to see her again..?" Cyrus asked, gently grasping his partner's hand.

"I'm nervous, because I know she's not a little kit anymore, but I know she's made us proud."

Squeaky laughter was suddenly heard approaching the throne room. The two turned just as a magicat entered, her arm around a pregnant blonde woman carrying a kitten, the three led by an alien feline they'd met a few moments ago.

"Alright alright, Melog what did you…" Catra gasped when she saw two magicats standing with Glimmer and Bow, "Sparkles… Who..?" was all she managed, her eyes unable to leave the men. Adora was just as speechless, having to shift her attention to keep her hold on Mara.

"Catra… Meet King Cyrus and Ezekiel! Or simply put, your dads!" Glimmer sniffed, both she and Bow had already begun crying.

Slowly, Catra glanced at Adora to make sure she was balanced, and once receiving a nod, carefully took steps to approach the men.

"C'yra..?" Ezekiel asked quietly, trying to fully process that this was really happening.

Only managing a tiny nod, Catra stopped a few steps in front of them, her breath hitching when she was suddenly enveloped in their arms. It was a strange feeling, but it was the closest one to home she had ever felt that wasn't related to Adora. Tears streaked her face as she buried her nose between her dads' shoulders.

"Dads…"

Chapter End Notes

Comments and kudos make my day!! I hope you all enjoyed the fluff, it will continue into the next chapter before the shadows return.

Settling In

Chapter Summary

> Catra and Adora introduce Mara to her grandfathers, and Catra's family expands just a little more.

Chapter Notes

> I'm sorry for not posting this on Monday, especially since it's a filler fluff chapter, but I was on vacation and just recently got back home! But I'm glad to get this out now, as the next update is diving back into the angstyyy

Meeting her dads for the first time had been a teary reunion, a hug that lasted at least twenty minutes. When they finally parted, Adora suggested they go to the library for proper introductions. Everyone was happy to oblige.

So, after thanking Glimmer and Bow extensively, Catra, her dads, Adora, Melog, and Mara found themselves in the library, sitting together on the couches, separated only by a coffee table.

"So, I take it this is your Mate?" Cyrus asked, bringing a blush to both women's faces.

"Yes, this is Adora. Also known as She-Ra."

That made the kings' eyes widen, "Wait- like- like-"

"The legendary warrior, yes. Not the same you've heard of from the past of course, but you know.." Adora cleared her throat, "Anyway, yes, we are engaged."

"And this is your kit?" Ezekiel asked, smiling at Mara, who was occupied with a stuffed animal in Catra's lap.

"Adopted, yes," Catra confirmed, "We found her when we went to explore the Halfmoon ruins. Some Horde Soldiers..her mother.." She trailed off, but her fathers nodded in understanding, "She was around six months old when we found her so her first birthday is actually coming up kinda soon." That brought a smile to everyone's faces.

"If I may ask, your highness-"

"-Adora, please." The blonde blushed.

"Right, Adora," Cyrus continued, "How far along are you?"

"Just approaching seven months." Adora rested a hand on her abdomen, smiling at the thought, "And before you ask, the ultrasounds have already shown that I'm carrying a magicat. We're all very excited to meet them."

"I have to admit, I'm grateful we were here now for both that and presumably your wedding?" Cyrus smiled.

"Of course. I actually have some questions about that. I've been trying to learn about our culture, but the library in Halfmoon has been… we couldn't find much, aside from your letter."

"You found the letter?" Ezekiel smiled, but it was saddened. Memories of how they'd come to create it were still fresh, "I'm glad to know you did, but yes, to answer your question. There's a lot about our kingdom and culture we never got to share with you, and it would be an honor to have a few things included at your wedding."

"I'd be honored to learn." Adora smiled, grasping her fiance's hand, who also nodded, just as enthusiastic, "We both grew up in the Frightzone together, and even years after the war have never found any special traditions. Up until now, neither of us have had our kingdoms."

"You aren't a princess of Brightmoon?" Cyrus raised an eyebrow, confused.

Adora shook her head, "Not technically, no. My title is just the Princess of Power, because She-Ra is a being meant to protect Etheria as a whole. Like I said, we grew up in the Horde, so until I found the sword I fought for them. But that's another long story." She chuckled, blushing with embarrassment, "My entire point was just that it'll be nice to learn about traditions once lost and help revive them."

Catra couldn't help but snort, "You made that clear, princess."

"Well, we'll be happy to teach you." Cyrus chuckled, "Most of what I can think of off hand would be certain accessories and customs within your vows, but we can take things as slow as you wish, given your state, Adora. Besides, this wedding will be after you give birth and recover I'm sure."

Color taking over her face once more, Adora slowly nodded.

"Then of course there's things outside of wedding things that we would be happy to teach you about."

"Of course!" Adora smiled, squeezing Catra's hand.

⚔

Over the next few hours, Catra and Adora learned about Halfmoon culture. They learned that typically, when a magicat chooses a mate, it's a mate for life. They also learned about collars, how sacred they were for a magicat, and how disrespectful it was for anyone other than their mate to place a collar on them.

Cyrus also took care to mention to Catra how protective instincts and jealousy would probably be something she'll experience often,

making the couple laugh. They already knew that much from experience.

Still, they took care to listen to everything they had to say, spending the entire afternoon through dinner with the men, Catra not wanting to be apart from them.

After dinner, they all retired to one of dens, Catra holding Adora in her arms while they watched Mara get to know her grandfathers.

"Grampy!" Mara exclaimed, looking up at Cyrus and holding up a stuffed lamb.

"Who's this?" Cyrus asked, smiling down at the kit.

"Wooly!"

"What a beautiful name, kit." Ezekiel chuckled, ruffling her hair.

"Her favorite toy is this stuffed animal cat she named Mew Mew," Catra smiled, her palm gently caressing Adora's bump.

"Mew Mew?" Mara gasped, looking up at Catra expectantly.

"She's in your crib, little one," Adora promised, "You'll get her when you go to bed."

"She's such a sweetheart," Cyrus hummed, his tail wrapping gently around the kitten, "Though it is getting late, perhaps we should all get some rest?"

"Sounds good, let me just take Adora and Mara to bed and I'll bring you both to a guest room." Catra explained, getting to her feet and helping Adora do the same.

⚔

"Okay, we set up this room for you both," Catra hummed as she pushed open the door to the room.

"Thank you, C'yra." Ezekiel smiled, gently wrapping his arms around his daughter, who sank into the embrace, "We're so proud of all you've accomplished."

"We love you so much." Cyrus added, kissing the top of her head.

Catra sniffed, tears running down her face, "I l-love you too… thank you…" She whimpered, clinging to her father's shoulders, "I actually wanted to ask if maybe we could visit Halfmoon together… I tried to figure some things out but with it in ruins it's

hard to understand everything." Catra knew it was a bit of a bad idea to go now because of Shadow Weaver, but she so desperately wanted to learn about her home and be with her dads that the thought was in the back of her mind.

"Of course we can," Cyrus nodded, "We'd love to see our home as well. Queen Glimmer mentioned wanting to help us rebuild as well, so hopefully we can soon call it home once again."

"Can't wait.." Catra smiled, wiping her eyes, "I should let you get some sleep."

"Sleep well, C'yra.." Ezekiel whispered, purring softly as he rested his forehead to Catra's, "We'll see you in the morning."

"Night, dads…" Catra nodded, giggling upon receiving a kiss on her cheek from each of them, before waving and making her way back to her own bedroom.

Her good mood only intensified when she entered her suite to find Mara laughing and cuddling with Mew Mew, and Adora watching comfortably from the bed.

"Everything okay?" Adora asked when she saw the damp fur on her finance's cheeks.

"Yeah, just.. I can't believe this is real.." She laughed, sliding into bed and cuddling up with Adora.

"I'm so happy for you," Adora smiled, kissing her cheek, "You deserve this and more.."

"I wish we could find your parents too.." Catra whispered, frowning.

"I came through a portal, Catra. That's practically impossible, but that's okay. I have all the family I need right here."

"You're such a sap." Catra chuckled.

"Only for you." Adora retorted, kissing her partner gently.

When they parted and glanced back to the crib, they were relieved to see that their kitten had finally fallen asleep, "Guess that's our cue huh?"

Adora snorted and nodded, resting her head on Catra's chest, "I love you.."

"I love you too, princess."

Once Called Home

Chapter Summary

> Returning to Halfmoon means that Catra finally gets to learn about her past from the fathers she's wished for her entire life. It also means facing the shadows of her past.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra sighed as she watched the shores of Halfmoon come into view. Saying goodbye to Adora and Mara had really been difficult this time. She knew Adora was still a couple months away from going into labor, but she still didn't like being away from her this late into the term. Still, she hated the thought of her fiance running into that monster even more, and because of that determined it was better for Glimmer to accompany her and her fathers to the island.

“Are you okay?”

Catra turned towards her friend, slowly nodding, “Yeah, just… worried, as usual.”

"That seems to be normal lately huh," Glimmer frowned, "You know Adora and Mara are safe with Bow right?"

"Of course I do. Really that's… not what's really bugging me. Shadow Weaver being…" She sighed.

"I don't believe you ever told us about this Shadow Weaver. Who is she?" Cyrus asked, placing a gentle hand on his daughter's shoulder.

"She raised Adora and I in the Horde. She was a horrible woman that treated me like I was nothing more than the dirt beneath her heel.." Catra growled, "She drove to me do things I'm not ready to discuss with you yet."

Cyrus and Ezekiel shared a look before turning and pulling their daughter gently into their embrace.

"W-what's this for..?" Catra asked, though leaned into the affection.

"A reminder of how much we love you, and how sorry we are for what you went through."

Tears slipped down Catra's face as she snuggled into their arms, "I love you too.."

⚔

By the time they docked their boat and stepped onto the island, Catra was feeling a little better. She had many hopes for this trip,

but wasn't sure how many of them would actually happen.

"Seems that our home remained somewhat stable," Cyrus chuckled as they followed the stone pathway to the large building, "Did you explore the palace when you first came here?"

"A bit, but we were mostly in the library."

"Would you mind giving us a tour?" Glimmer asked, "It'd be nice to know the history behind it and give us a better picture of what it used to look like, and hopefully look like again."

"We'd love to!" Ezekiel exclaimed, smiling at the thought.

Catra smiled as well, allowing her fathers to lead them inside, "I still wonder what it would have been like to grow up here…"

"I imagine meeting your mate would have been more difficult," Ezekiel chuckled.

"I know, and I don't think I'd have things play out any differently I just… wonder, I guess."

"That's fair, I do wish we'd never lost you, but I'm glad you've found happiness now." Cyrus hummed, placing a hand on the

small of her back as they went down the hall.

"Yeah, me too…" Catra smiled, blushing at the thought of Adora back home waiting for her.

"By the way.." Glimmer cut in, smirking in a way Catra knew she was about to embarrass her, "If Catra.. left as a kitten, does that mean her room here is still a nursery?"

"Oh, yes!" Ezekiel perked up, "Her room was right down here!" He exclaimed, quickly making his way down to one of the large double doors.

"Sparkles I will murder you." Catra growled, half joking as she was guided into the room by her father.

The room was just as adorable as Glimmer expected, even with the age and dust that came with decades of abandonment.

A large window was in the middle of the wall, faded but colorful warm colored curtains covering it. A crib was in front of it, little pillows surrounding the tiny bed to form somewhat of a nest, and a fluffy red blanket still crumbled in the middle. A rocking chair sat off to the side near a changing table and shelf that contained books and toys. Then on the opposite side sat a wardrobe and a pedestal that once held her crown. Lastly, the room was decorated with a round rug in the center and a corner of enough old toys to satisfy all the kids in the Brightzone Orphanage.

"Wow…" Catra gasped, eyes wide as she slowly walked through the room, brushing her fingers delicately across the side of her old crib.

"So that nesting thing you do isn't just a one off thing?" Glimmer asked, noting the excessive pillows in the crib, her eyes sparkling with how adorable it was.

"Sparkles-!" Catra started, only to be interrupted by Cyrus.

"It's actually quite common, normally for pregnant magicats or when they need to feel especially close to their Mate or just needing a feeling of safety in general. It was always common to give kittens that feeling so they felt safe to sleep through the night when they no longer were in the room with their parents."

"Swaddling kittens was also an easy way to calm them when they're less than a year old." Ezekiel added, "That was the only way to settle C'yra the first few months." He recalled the memory with a warm smile.

"Aweee!" Glimmer cooed, giggling as she imagined it.

Catra, however, was blushing furiously in embarrassment, despite the smile trying to fight its way onto her face, "I'm so glad Adora

isn't here now. But that does explain.. a lot when it comes to my childhood and- Horde days, in general."

"Have you ever tried those things with Mara?" Cyrus asked.

"No, I think swaddling her would only scare her given the circumstances. I have seen her make little nests though."

"I'm willing to bet that's where my extra pillows went." Glimmer chuckled.

"In the corner of our room? Probably." Catra smiled, before turning to her dads, "Thanks for showing us this…"

"Of course, honey." Ezekiel smiled, pressing his forehead to hers and purring gently, "Even if we've been gone longer than we'd like, we can still tell you anything we can about when we were last together."

Nodding, Catra began softly purring as well, lightly hugging him before they parted.

"Shall we continue the tour?" Cyrus prompted, the others nodding before leaving the nursery behind.

⚔

"This has been such a wonderful experience," Glimmer smiled, speaking up after the mostly silent walk back to the throne room, "And I hate to be the one to bring this up, but we did come here to find Shadow Weaver too."

"I can't decide if I want to find her corpse or not." Catra grumbled, her tail swaying in anger.

"I'm almost scared to ask what she did to deserve such a comment.." Ezekiel frowned.

"Exist." Glimmer and Catra said in unison.

"We'll get into details when I'm more ready, promise." Catra said, looking up at her dads before looking around after they nodded, "If she is alive, she's got to be around here somewhere. The camp we found Mara in is in the courtyard."

"You know, I remember there was this little cave not too far from the palace," Cyrus pondered aloud, "I remember playing there as a child."

"Oh yeah!" Ezekiel smiled, "We used to sneak away there when parties and festivals became too much for you. I could easily see

someone taking refuge there. It's quiet and deep enough to shield one from the elements."

"Lead the way then!" Glimmer said, the four making their way from the palace and past the courtyard. It took them around ten minutes of walking, as they had to reach the small forest that surrounded most of the island, but once they reached it, the cave in question was quickly located.

Catra was the first to take a step into the cave, her ears flickering as she listened for signs of life. While she didn't hear anyone, she did hear the faint sound of a fire crackling, "Someone's in here."

"Likely her. Ready?" Glimmer asked, serious as she gave her friend a look of concern.

Catra took a deep breath, "I'm ready. More than ready actually." She sounded more confident than she felt, but she was feeling ready to face the woman that tormented her for so many years, especially with her fathers standing behind her.

The queen nodded, walking next to Catra, the kings following behind as they all made their way into the cave.

"Hello, Catra." was the next thing they heard as they approached the small fire, the woman identified as Shadow Weaver by voice alone slumped against the wall nearby.

Hissing, Catra glared at the witch, her tail now lashing behind her, "Shadow Weaver." She spat in return.

"All these years and you still hold such hatred."

"As if *you* of all people have the right to say that." Glimmer snapped.

"I suppose none of us can really say much can we, your majesty?"

Catra growled, forcing herself to not unsheathe her claws, afraid of what she might do, "Why are you here, Shadow Weaver?"

"I'm dying, Catra."

"I thought you did that years ago! Then I find out you've apparently been in my kingdom trying to access my runestone using an innocent baby!"

"Your kingdom?" Shadow Weaver raised an eyebrow, thinking for a moment before she finally looked at the two magicats beyond Catra, and everything suddenly dawned on her.

Catra took the look of surprise on her abuser's face as a prompt to continue, "Yeah, turns out Adora wasn't the only princess out there. And I was *born* one, yet you still saw me as useless. Why? Why was I always nothing to you? Why was I just a little pest for you to take your anger out on? Why was I never good enough?" She didn't realize she was crying until Cyrus gently engulfed her in a hug.

"I don't think any answer I provide will ever be the one you want to hear, Catra." Shadow Weaver hummed, making scarce eye contact with the feline, "I always knew you were strong, powerful like Adora was,"

"Then *why* -"

The sorceress held up a finger, "Perhaps it was because you've always been a rebel, through and through. You've never fallen in line and listened like Adora did. You were smart, you knew the Horde was evil all along, something Adora didn't believe until she found the sword. You understood what was really happening, yet you stayed because of Adora. I suppose I knew no matter what you wouldn't ever just leave, because you craved approval from those around you. It's a shame you didn't want it from Adora more than Hordak or me; maybe you would have followed her that day, saved Etheria a lot of trouble."

"Hey! As Queen, I've made it clear Catra has been pardoned for any war crimes, and has done nothing wrong. Well, okay, she *did* , but we all did. The majority of her actions were promoted solely from the mind of a traumatized child." Glimmer glared daggers at the old woman.

"If that's what lets you sleep at night." Shadow Weaver responded simply.

Knowing they weren't going to get a straight answer, Catra decided to move on, "How did you get here anyway?"

"Well, after I teleported that monster and myself to Beast Island, surprisingly surviving the process. I managed to scrape together enough old transport pieces to make a raft over time, and found myself here after a few days, a week, somewhere in there. I found some Horde Soldiers on the run, scavenging, and we found that kitten and its mother. That's when I realized where we were. I was just trying to activate the runestone with hopes of connecting to the magic to heal myself."

"Yeah well, that little girl is mine and Adora's daughter now because those monsters you partnered with killed her mother and tortured her!"

"What they did I have no knowledge of. I found the kitten couldn't do what I needed, and left it with them. I am surprised to hear of *you* of all people as a parent though."

"An *amazing* parent. Something she's become no thanks to you!" Glimmer huffed.

"Speaking of Adora, where is she? If you two are so in love why aren't you together?"

"If you must know, she's at home, safe with Bow because she's seven months pregnant." Catra replied with a small smirk and venom in her voice. Her moment of 'look what I did without you'.

"Another surprise. Well, I hope you know what you're getting into."

"While that's none of your business, we didn't just come to chat. You're coming back to Brightmoon. You have a lot of crimes of your own to face." Glimmer crossed her arms.

"Pardons only for friends I'd guess," The sorceress said, not even trying to move from her spot.

"No, but one good deed doesn't fix a lifetime of errors."

"And yet Hordak walks free?"

"That-" Glimmer groaned, "He didn't walk 'free'. He's technically incarcerated in Dryl. But- even still! War crimes *aside* you've got much more underneath your belt. So get up, we have a *long* trip back to Brightmoon."

Chapter End Notes

I have been so hyped for this chapter because I know you will find it adorable and also piss you off. Shadow Weaver really can't give a straight answer can she?

Labors of Law

Chapter Summary

> The Alliance has to figure out what to do with Shadow Weaver, how to rebuild Halfmoon, and make sure Adora is safe!

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"You realize we're going to have to have a trial right?"

"I know." Catra sighed, dreading the moment she would to retell and relive every traumatic moment Shadow Weaver had inflicted on her.

"We'll take our time with it. We know she's never walking free again, so we can make sure everyone is prepared beforehand, 'kay?" Glimmer promised, placing a gentle hand on her friend's shoulder.

"Thanks, Sparkles," Catra smiled, before turning and pulling the shorter woman into a hug, which was returned in earnest, "We don't have to worry about her dying for real beforehand do we?"

"Nah, we have healers keeping an eye on her." Glimmer snorted, "If anyone should have to answer to her crimes she's the most deserving."

"Even over Prime?" Catra chuckled, finally pulling away from the embrace.

"They're tied." The queen decided.

"Fair enough. Oh, I'm headed to Brightzone, Adora's napping and she knows where I'm going, but if she wakes up just- remind her for me? And of course come get me if need be."

"Of course! Don't forget about our meeting later though. We're finally getting started on reconstructing Halfmoon."

"How could I forget?" Catra smiled, "I'll be there."

Glimmer nodded and waved, watching her friend walk off before teleporting off to find Bow.

⚔

Spending another afternoon at the orphanage was euphoric for Catra. She had been watching the kids grow before her eyes, many even being adopted and placed in loving homes. She'd seen a few with their new families, all excited to see her and tell her about their new parents and rooms.

She only wished she was able to spend more time there like she used to when it first opened, but she trusted Spinnerella and Netossa, who'd taken to running the place in her place. They didn't have children or kingdoms of their own, and always seemed the happiest there with the kids.

They did follow her back to the castle for the meeting though, leaving the other caretakers in charge until they could return.

She could see confusion on Adora's face when she entered the room, quickly approaching and sitting next to her, "Hey, Adora. Everything alright?"

Adora smiled, taking her fiance's hand once it was offered, "Yeah just.. I still haven't been told why we're having a meeting."

"Remember when I told you we brought Shadow Weaver back from Halfmoon..?"

"Ooh…" Frowning, the blonde nodded in understanding.

"You just relax okay? I know you wanna be here but don't pressure yourself.." Catra hummed, gently rubbing Adora's baby bump and drawing a content sigh from her, "We also have to start reconstruction on Halfmoon, so it's not all about her."

Nodding again, Adora let her eyes drift closed, enjoying the affection from Catra.

"Alright! I think we're all here." Glimmer announced once Cryus and Ezekiel entered the room, taking seats near Catra, who offered them a smile.

"Thank you all for coming. I know we were originally just here to talk about reconstruction in Halfmoon, but we also have a new addition to the docket." The queen took a deep breath, "King Cyrus, Ezekiel, Catra, and I went to Halfmoon and found Shadow Weaver hiding there."

That alone was enough to elicit gasps and angered groans from the table.

"We're going to have to put her on trial by law, just as we did with Hordak. We need to figure out when to set it up."

"The faster we do it the better." Micah sighed, "I know waiting would be better considering the circumstances, but legally we can only hold her for two weeks without a trial."

"Seriously?" Catra groaned, "I don't think anyone would be opposed to breaking that law."

"You've studied the laws as much as I have by now, Catra. We know we can't do that."

Huffing, Catra crossed her arms, "Fine, whatever. But she stays in chains and under some kind of spell to prevent her from using magic. She might be weak but I refuse to take any chances. Especially around Adora."

"Catra I'd be fine.." Adora tried, blushing at the look she received in return. It was a mix of possessive and protective instinct, but she didn't mind. She knew her fiance only wanted to help.

"Adora, I love you, and I trust you, but I don't want that woman within fifty feet of you."

"Okay…" Adora hummed, smiling when Catra's tail wrapped around her wrist.

"I guess we'll aim for next week then." Glimmer sighed, "The sooner we get it over with the better I suppose. Anyway, on more important matters, how should we move forward with reviving Halfmoon?"

Once again, Catra took the floor, "I've been thinking about that. Before we do anything else, we need to rebuild the castle. That way we can figure out the best way to rebuild the surrounding village. I spent some time with my- dads," Catra smiled softly at them, "And sketched out the island as they described it, so we

have this." She took the page Cyrus offered, placing it on the center of the table for everyone to see, "I think we should make a camp on the island and send builders out to work. Make sure everyone has trackerpads so we can send supplies whenever we need to."

"Sounds like a solid plan." Glimmer smiled.

"Once the palace is built, Ezekiel and I will be able to move back ourselves to direct the rest of the project." Cyrus added.

"That would be very appreciated." Glimmer nodded, "Have you spoken with the magicats still in the Waste?"

"We have, they'll also return once the palace is built." Ezekiel confirmed.

"Perfect, in that case we just need to-"

The meeting was interrupted by a sudden gasp from Adora. Everyone turned to see her clutching her bump and gasping for breath.

"A-Adora?! Are you okay?" Catra gasped, eyes widening as she crouched by her partner.

"I- I don't-" She cried out again, gripping tightly onto Catra's shoulders.

"Sparkles!" Catra shouted, turning to the queen, who'd already rushed to her side.

"Hold on, Adora, it's gonna be okay!" Glimmer assured them before teleporting them to the infirmary.

⚔

"Is she okay?!" Bow asked the moment Catra walked out of the infirmary. Cyrus and Ezekiel were a few feet away. He was cradling Mara in one arm while Glimmer held his other.

"She's okay. False labor. Doctor Althea said that means she's probably going to deliver a week or two earlier than we expected."

"I'm not surprised to be honest. Most magicats are born slightly earlier than their given due date." Cyrus said, "If I had thought about it I would have mentioned it, I'm sorry."

"It's okay, dad." Catra smiled, lifting Mara into her arms when the kitten reached for her.

"Mommy otay?"

"Mommy is okay, little one. She just needed some sleep."

"Otay," Mara smiled, giggling when Catra kissed her forehead.

"At least she's alright. We were really worried." Bow sighed, relieved.

"So I'm guessing she's sleeping now then?" Glimmer asked.

"Yeah. We'll move her back to our suite when she wakes up."

"Alright. I'm guessing you'll be staying with her."

"Of course I am, Sparkles," She chuckled before turning to her parents, "After a couple hours can you come get Mara?"

"Of course, honey." Ezekiel smiled.

"Thanks. I'll see you guys then, but I wanna get back to her side and I think Mara needs to see her too."

"Agreed. We'll see you for dinner?" Bow asked.

"Yeah. Whether I'm there with Adora or just picking up dinner is another thing I'll figure out later."

"Right. Alright, we're headed back to let everyone know she's okay."

Catra nodded, waving to them before returning to the infirmary, cradling Mara in her arms.

Chapter End Notes

Hahaha you thought Adora went into labor didn't you? >:)

On Trial

Chapter Summary

> Shadow Weaver is finally being put on trial for all of the crimes she has committed. While nervous, Catra and Adora are determined to get justice from the woman that abused them for so long.

Chapter Notes

> All rise for the honorable judge Micah! *slams gavel*
>
> TW// Details of Mara's abuse are talked about, and it gets a little gruesome

Adora groaned as she woke up, probably for the fifth time that night. She tightened her hold on Catra's hand, hearing her purrs on her left and Melog's on her right.

"Are you okay, baby? Do you need anything?"

"No…" Adora whispered, relaxing under Catra's touch as she rubbed her bump.

"Mm hm…" Adora shook her head, "Just… can't sleep."

"I understand… you don't have to testify tomorrow you know. The shit she did to me and Glimmer alone is more than enough."

"No… I need to." The blonde finally opened her eyes, looking up at her fiancé, "I need to face her a-and show her she doesn't control me anymore. I know what she did to me wasn't nearly as-" She was cut off by Catra pressing a finger to her lips.

"Nope. Not going there. Abuse is abuse, doesn't matter what kind, and I won't have you minimizing yours for my sake."

"But-"

"No, Adora." Her voice was more firm now, "She abused you, she controlled and manipulated you for *years* . You still have nightmares too, so stop acting like it was nothing."

Tears ran down Adora's face. She whimpered when Catra wrapped her arms around her, pulling her in close and pressing little kisses to her cheek and temple, "I love you…" was all she could manage to get out.

"I love you too, my princess," Catra whispered, running her fingers gently through Adora's hair, "Now say it."

Though she whined again, Adora closed her eyes and answered anyway, "She abused me…just like she abused you…neither is worse than the other.."

"Good job." Catra praised, smiling and rewarding her with kisses across her face. She was happy to draw small giggles out of her partner, "Let's try and get some sleep okay?"

"Okay…" Adora felt more comfortable once Catra cuddled up close to her, holding her protectively in the little nest of pillows Catra had curated over the past week. It took a few minutes, but soon enough she was able to finally fall asleep for the night, the trial in the back of her mind.

⚔

Because the entire alliance had to attend the trial, Adora and Catra wound up having to bring Mara with them. Luckily, they were sitting at their own table on the prosecution side, and had space for a portable crib. It also helped that Glimmer and Bow's table was next to them, so the crib was able to sit between them and give all four of them easy access to the kitten for any given reason. Cyrus, Ezekiel, Perfuma and Scorpia were also in the first row of benches on standby, just in case by Catra's request.

Catra had required the defendant table to be as far away from them as possible, so Shadow Weaver would be sitting on one of the witness stands by Micah and guards the entire time, while they would hear testimonies from Catra, Adora, and Glimmer from their tables. Using Mara and Adora's pregnancy were enough of an excuse anyway, but Micah had no issue with his daughter and her friends being as far away from that monster as possible.

"Are you guys ready? The guards are about to escort her in." Glimmer asked the couple, who both looked nervous, one more so than the other.

Catra nodded, adjusting the pins on her shirt, one Adora's wing pin, and the other her Royal Advisor badge that Glimmer had given her.

Adora had felt self conscious the entire morning. While Catra, Glimmer, and Bow were all formally dressed for court, all she could fit in was a white and yellow sundress. She looked more ready for a date than a war criminal's court trial in her opinion.

"You look beautiful, Adora.." Catra whispered, sensing the nerves, "I don't think anyone will blame a heavily pregnant woman for how she dresses, especially when everyone here is your friend or family."

Nodding, Adora grabbed Catra's hand, and glanced over at Mara. The kitten was quietly turning through a picture book with teething covers, and hugging her bunny plush. They'd purposely given her quiet toys, and left a bottle with baby formula in it for her. Adora was glad she was happy at least.

Micah finally gave Glimmer a nod, and the queen took a deep breath and teleported to the front next to him, "If I could have everyone's attention, Brightmoon Supreme Court is now in session. I will be turning over the title of judge to my father today, given that his truth spells will come in handy, and I don't believe I have enough experience yet. So with that, I'll turn things over."

She smiled at her dad before teleporting back to her seat next to Bow.

"Thank you," Micah said simply, finding that referring to Glimmer as anything but his baby girl was still difficult, "To begin, we will now bring in the defendant."

The doors opened, and the air felt suddenly more chilly and scarce to many as General Juliet and a few other guards began to walk Shadow Weaver into the room. Per Catra's requirements, she was shackled at the ankles and wrists, and had all of her sorcery blocked by a spell Micah had cast on her before the trial began.

Catra, Bow, and Glimmer had glares fixed on their faces as she was led to the stand, while Adora remained neutral as the moment sunk in.

Adora felt chills run down her spine when she saw Shadow Weaver look her up and down after being seated on the stand. She knew she looked anything but like the 'great warrior' that she'd always told Adora she would be.

"I would like to start by explaining the charges against the defendant." Micah began, not even bothering to bring his notes as he began to pace the front of the room, "The defendant has been charged with five accounts of child abuse, two counts of treason to Etheria, conspiracy to theft of Etherian magic, one count of attempted sorcery of forbidden magic, two counts of attempted manslaughter, one count of murder in the second degree, multiple accounts of assistance in kidnapping children, two counts of theft

of magic from a runestone, one count of preventing a princess from connecting to her runestone, multiple accounts of criminal harrassment of royalty, one account of kidnapping a princess for ransom, and one account of attempted memory alteration of a princess."

By the time Micah finished explaining the charges, Catra had dug a groove into the table with her claws, itching to bring justice for herself and those around her.

"Before hearing testimonies from the prosecution, I have a question for the defendant." Micah finally graced his attention in Shadow Weaver's direction, "Would you like to tell us how you plead to these charges?"

"No contest."

Catra barely suppressed a groan, rolling her eyes. She was surprised she didn't simply deny the charges completely, but this was somehow more agitating.

She guessed it was meant to be.

"I would first like to question Princess of Halfmoon and Royal Advisor to Brightmoon, Catra." Micah continued, turning his attention to the magicat, who straightened up in her seat, nodding gently, "Are you okay with being placed under a truth spell?"

"Yes." Catra replied, closing her eyes when she felt the wave of magic pass over her moments later.

"Could you please describe your earliest memory with the defendant?"

Taking a deep breath, Catra let her tail wrap around Adora's calf before she began speaking, "I had just been found by Adora in a box on the edge of the Frightzone. By our guess, we were around four and five, and Adora had just brought me inside when Shadow Weaver found us. She thought I was a stray animal and demanded Adora throw me back outside, but she refused, holding me close and insisting I could stay with her. Shadow Weaver reluctantly agreed, under the terms that Adora kept me "under control" and out of the way. I knew even as a kit she hated me."

"When was the first time she physically abused you?"

"Not even a week after I arrived. She "caught" me scratching on one of the posts of Adora's bunk bed. I was only doing it because my claws were still growing and were hurting, and that was the only way I could find to help file them down. She picked me up by the scruff of my neck and brought me to the Black Garnett Chamber and threw me to the ground before hitting me with her magic, shocking me over and over again.. She didn't stop until I blacked out."

Catra flinched when she felt a hand on her shoulder. She turned to see Cyrus gripping her shoulder gently, both of her dads holding almost unreadable expressions.

"Could you give us a rough estimate of how often she would use her magic on you?"

"Every other day, if not daily. It was so often. She's the reason I feared magic for so long, and why I was so repelled by the thought of princesses because of their powers. I thought everyone used their magic like she did. I- I thought… I never thought magic could be a good thing until Adora saved me from Prime's ship." She wiped her eyes before the tears could fall.

"And what proof do you have of these acts I supposedly inflicted on you?"

Shadow Weaver's sudden input made Catra snap to attention. The fire returned to her eyes almost immediately, "I'm glad you asked." She turned to Glimmer and nodded, and the queen proceeded to draw a rune that displayed what was effectively a large projected screen. Displayed was a photo of Catra's back, which was lined top to bottom with red scars, clearly inflicted via electrocution.

The gasps from behind her was enough to feel like her point had gotten across. "Thank you, Glimmer."

The queen nodded before dismissing the image.

"That photo was taken three days ago, and it shows the extensive damage she's done to me physically."

"What about mentally?" Micah asked, his tone soft and understanding. He could feel the rage radiating off the magicat kings. It was a fatherly rage he understood well.

"She drove me to things I never want to relive. I felt so worthless, especially after…well, after Adora left, but that's a different story. Despite everything though, she was the only parental figure I've ever had until recently, and I always felt like I had something to prove to her. I wanted to be seen as worthy to her, I wanted to make her proud of me.."

"And now?"

"Now?" Catra scoffed, "Now she needs to prove her worth to me. She's the one who's nothing but a prisoner now. She's not a princess, or a royal advisor. She's not marrying She-Ra, or taking care of the orphans she helped kidnap years ago. That's all *me* . I'm proud of who I've become with the help of my family, and how far I've come over the years. What she thinks of me is completely irrelevant."

"Thank you, Catra. That'll be all for now."

Nodding and slowly letting out a breath she'd been holding, Catra relaxed in her chair, smiling at the look Adora was giving her. It was a clear message that said she was proud of her.

"Now, due to the fact that she's expecting, we will not be placing a truth spell over Princess Adora, instead using the traditional oath of honesty." Micah explained before turning his attention to the blonde in question, "Can you raise your right hand, please?"

Adora nodded, gently lifting her right hand from the table.

"Do you swear to tell the whole truth and nothing but the truth in this court today?"

"I do."

"Thank you. You may lower your hand." Micah smiled, giving Adora a moment before beginning the questions.

"Can you describe your childhood being raised by the defendant?"

"She raised me to believe that I was going to lead the Horde to victory. She told me that I would be the greatest Force Captain in history, that I was destined for greatness. She was hard on me, pushing me to learn techniques and training simulations years

before most cadets would. If I showed even the slightest form of hesitation, she would say something along the lines of risking what "I" had always wanted. She always made me think that her ambitions were my wants."

"How did she act around you when Catra was around?"

"She would treat her like my pet project…" Tears were already running down her face, "She always made it clear that she was my responsibility, a-and I always felt if I wasn't good enough in training or- or during tests that she would take her away from me..! I was always so terrified of losing her that I pushed myself to the limits, often ignoring Catra to work harder. I was just- so focused on keeping Catra safe and keeping Shadow Weaver happy that I f-failed at both…" Adora sniffed and covered her face, only moving when she felt Catra wrap her arms around her shoulders. She leaned into the embrace.

"What about after She-Ra?" Micah asked after a moment, making sure that Adora had seemed to calm down before proceeding.

"She started telling me that I was born to be the hero of Etheria. She pushed me to take the Failsafe, knowing that I was struggling to access She-Ra and knowing it would likely kill me, and technically, though temporary, it did."

The memory of thinking Adora had passed made Bow, Glimmer, and Catra tense. Even years later, the mental image of Adora lifeless in Catra's arms was not one they'd ever forget.

To their surprise, even Shadow Weaver looked shocked at the news.

"If it wasn't for Catra, and the love she has for me, I wouldn't be here." She added, mostly for Shadow Weaver's ears.

Micah nodded, "Under the list of charges, I'm aware that the count of attempting to alter a royal's memory is a transgression against you, as well as criminal harassment of a royal. Can you explain the situation with your memory?"

"She was holding Glimmer for ransom, wanting to force the late Queen Angella to surrender to the Horde for her safety. When I arrived, I agreed to stay willing if she let Glimmer go. She strapped me to a table and told me she was going to erase my memory of the Rebellion, and that once she had I would be h-happy to have Glimmer as my prisoner…"

"What stopped her?"

"Glimmer managed to escape in time. If she hadn't…" Adora trailed off, not wanting to fathom that future.

"And the criminal harassment?"

"You should ask Catra, I don't know the entirety, only what she told me."

Micah glanced towards the brunette to prompt her to explain, "After Adora defected, Shadow Weaver became obsessed with getting her back. Even after Hordak demanded she move on, she continued to send me and Princess Scorpia on missions to find her and bring her back. She would use her shadow spies and her cauldron to spy on her every move."

"And you saw her do these things?"

"On many occasions, yes, but I'm sure she did it even if I wasn't around."

After hearing the first two powerful testimonies, Micah decided a break was more than both needed and deserved, having guards escort Shadow Weaver to a holding cell while everyone else took a moment to relax.

⚔

"How are you two feeling?" Glimmer asked, watching as Catra cradled Mara, giving the laughing kitten little kisses to her forehead.

"Surprisingly pretty good," Catra hummed, before looking at Adora, "What about you?"

"I'm okay.. a little more emotional than I was prepared for though."

"That's to be expected, Adora. You're under a lot right now." Bow offered a sympathetic smile.

"I know, I'm just glad that my part is over for the most part."

"Mommy!"

Adora couldn't help but smile when her daughter called out to her, "Yes, lovely?"

Mara responded by reaching out and grabbing at the blonde, not stopping until she was passed into her arms, "Mama kissy, now mommy kissy!"

Snorting, Adora peppered kisses onto Mara's forehead, "You're so adorable, little one…" She cooed.

Catra watched the scene with a warm smile until she once again felt her father place a hand on her shoulder, "I can't even begin to

imagine how you grew up, honey…" Cyrus whispered. Both he and Ezekiel had moved to be next to the table, the latter now crouched at her side.

"It's okay dad, I'm fine now. It wasn't your fault. Nobody is to blame for her actions but her."

Though he nodded, the guilt still remained in his gaze, "Well, either way, we are so proud of you for standing up to her."

"The courage you've shown is one to be rivaled." Ezekiel praised, kissing the top of her head.

"Thank you…" Catra blushed, standing momentarily to hug both of her dads, "I love you dads…" She added in a whisper.

"We love you too, so so much." Ezekiel replied.

"Catra?"

Hearing her fiancé, Catra turned to Adora, "Yes?"

"Sorry to interrupt, but can you pass me Mara's bottle?"

"Oh! Of course." Grabbing the bottle from the crib, she handed it to Adora after sitting back down.

"Tank yous mama." Mara smiled, taking the bottle from Adora and beginning to drink from it.

"You're very welcome, little one." She replied, ruffling her tuft of hair.

⚔

When court resumed, Adora continued to cradle Mara, as the kitten had fallen asleep in her arms and she didn't have the heart to set her down and risk disturbing her.

"We left off after discussing the charges of criminal harassment and attempting to alter a royal's memory." Micah recapped, "Now I would like to discuss the charge of kidnapping a princess for ransom." He turned to Glimmer, "Would you explain what happened please?"

"She had locked me up in an electric trap, one that would shock me any time I tried to teleport out. For weeks after the event, I would glitch and be randomly shocked when trying to use my powers."

"I was told she also later used magic from the Moonstone through you?"

"Yes. She tricked me into giving her access to the runestone so we could teleport to the Frightzone to save Adora. But she used more and more, even nearly strangling Catra to death with my power."

"Are there other instances where she manipulated you?"

"Yes. After my coronation she got into my head, convinced me to give her free reign of the castle. She pushed me into thinking that using the Heart of Etheria would win us the war. Instead, I brought Prime here and nearly killed us all."

Micah nodded, taking a deep breath. The trial had been difficult already, but the next part would arguably be the most difficult for the majority of them.

"Catra, you found baby Mara on Halfmoon when you all visited for the first time. Could you please describe her condition?"

Catra tensed, looking at the kitten as she spoke, "Her eyes were closed, despite her being around six months old. She was shivering and way too thin. She was alone in a box and the way she clung to me the moment I picked her up is one I will never forget. They-"

"You are not seriously going to blame me for whatever happened to your illegitimate child are you?" Her objection was much louder this time, causing Mara to stir, her ears pinning to the sides of her head as she whimpered.

"We *know* you were involved." Catra growled, glaring at the woman, "You're the reason she was dying and so injured when I found her!"

"I did not put the adhesive near her or clip her claws. That was-"

"YOU WHAT?!" Catra, Cyrus, and Ezekiel all exclaimed at the same time. The only regret of the outburst being that it caused Mara to burst into tears, clinging to Adora, who rocked her gently. Despite the anger coursing through her veins, Adora managed to subdue her emotions to her glowing eyes as she comforted the kitten.

Being the quickest, Glimmer had teleported to the stand and grabbed Shadow Weaver by the collar of her shirt before guards or Micah could protest, "What did you do to her claws you bastard?!"

" *I* did nothing. Ivone was the one with the clippers."

"I don't believe you!" Catra growled, extending her own claws as far as they would go.

"Everyone calm down." Micah commanded, gentle but stern as he ushered his daughter back to her seat, "I believe there's a simple solution to learn the truth." He turned back to the defendant, glaring her down with his own gaze of hatred as he cast a truth spell over her, "What did you do to Mara?"

Though she struggled, the truth finally, *finally* , came out, "I ushered Ivone and Lynx to keep the child's eyes closed so she wouldn't be able to see anything coming and be less likely to try and attack or defend herself. I had them hold her still while I tried to declaw her, but only succeeded in taking her left pointed finger, as that's when her mother showed up and we got busy."

Shadow Weaver was the only person in the room who hadn't shed a tear.

"I've heard enough." Micah managed, blinking away tears as he cleared his throat, "I believe it's time to move forward."

⚔

The rest of the trial went by much smoother. They went over Shadow Weaver keeping the power of Black Garnett Chamber to herself, and preventing Scorpia from connecting to it, as well her control and abuse of Micah and the murder committed when she cast the Spell of Obtainment.

It took the entire day to thoroughly get through the very extensive list of charges.

By the end, the Alliance got together in the meeting room (formally the war room) to discuss the sentencing.

"I think we can all agree on life minimum?" Glimmer said, not surprised at the entourage of agreement that followed.

"Life in a solitary cell, guarded enough to make sure she can't attempt to escape and can be healed if she needs to be." Catra growled, still shaking from the news of Mara's abuse.

"All in agreement?" Glimmer asked. There wasn't a single hand that wasn't raised in agreement.

⚔

"Is there anything you'd like to say before your sentence is read?" Micah asked.

"No." Shadow Weaver responded, her tone made it clear it was simply another move that successfully shot anger through the prosecutioners.

"In that case, you are hereby sentenced to life imprisonment in the solitary wing of the prison. You will have no opportunity for parole."

Anger took over Shadow Weaver's expression, but she somehow managed to stay silent as she was escorted out of the room and to her cell.

⚔

"Catra, maybe you should just let it go for now…" Adora urged as she watched her fiancé examine Mara's hand. The kitten continued to whine and try to pull her hand away.

"I know I know I just.." Catra sighed, finally letting go and leaning back against her pillows. Mara whimpered and curled up against Catra, "I'm sorry baby, mama is just worried…"

Babbling, Mara nuzzled her chest, a tiny purr emitting from her as she relaxed.

Adora smiled, reaching over and rubbing Mara's back, "We love you so much, little one…"

"Wuv mommies too.." The kitten mumbled, already falling asleep.

"At least she's finally gone?"

"Yeah… I definitely needed this today."

"Me too.." Adora hummed, taking Catra's hand, "Let's take tomorrow to focus on us. Okay?"

"Sounds like a plan. This was the longest day we've had in years."

"You can say that again. The only thing I'm doing for the next few days is sleeping, eating, and spending time with my family."

"I like the sound of that." Catra purred, wrapping her free arm around her fiancé. Adora was happy to let the purrs of her family lull her to sleep.

Finn

Chapter Summary

After a long road, Catra and Adora are finally ready to welcome little Finn into the world.

Chapter Notes

A bit of a shorter chapter, but it's SO MUCH FLUFFFF

Turns out that relaxing with her family would be extremely short lived for Adora. A week and a half to be exact, before she went into sudden labor, her water breaking one evening just after dinner. They'd been on their way to bed, so luckily guards, as well as Bow, Glimmer, and Catra's parents were all around to quickly help Adora to the medical wing.

It only took an hour for contractions to settle after getting Adora into a medical gown.

"How are you feeling baby..?" Catra whispered, brushing a strand of hair out of Adora's face.

"I… I dunno.." Adora had already put up a fight when getting the first painkiller IV, and Catra was terrified of how she'd react if she needed an epidural.

"Is there anything you need?"

"No.. just- just stay."

"Of course, princess." Catra smiled, giving Adora's hand a gentle squeeze and a kiss to her palm.

⚔

After three hours, another sudden attack of contractions made it clear an epidural was needed. After consulting her dads to make sure it was safe, and Adora confirming ten more times she needed it, Catra got the doctor.

"I changed my mind!" Adora practically screamed when she saw the needle.

"Adora, just look at me, it's okay!"

Tears were already running down Adora's face as she stared at Catra. She'd already sat up, her back vulnerable to the needle. She had a vice grip on the brunette's hands as the epidural was administered, drawing a shriek from Adora.

"You're doing so good, baby, it's almost done…" Catra whispered to her, peppering little kisses to her cheeks until they were able to lay her back down.

"There we go… just try and relax, my love…" Catra assured, wiping her tears with her thumb before guiding her to lay back against the bed.

⚔

"Auntie Gwimmer?"

"Yes, sweetie?"

"When can I see mommy and momma?"

“In a little bit, mommy is… doing something important.” Glimmer looked to the others, not sure how to explain childbirth to an eleven month old.

"I wanna see momma…" Mara pouted, already tearing up.

"Sweetie, momma and mommy are busy right now, but they'll come get you as soon as possible.." Cyrus tried, crouching in front of the whining kitten.

Unfortunately, being too young to understand, and feeling left behind by her moms, Mara burst into tears, screaming for Catra.

"What are we supposed to do?" Bow bit his lip.

Glimmer stood, passing Mara to Cyrus, "Be right back."

"Glimmer you can't-"

Before Bow could protest, the queen had teleported into the infirmary.

⚔

Adora had finally relaxed, only to flinch when Glimmer suddenly teleported into the room.

"What the hell, Sparkles!" Catra hissed.

"I'm sorry, but Mara is screaming for you right now and I didn't want to just bring her in!"

Ears pinning, Catra looked to Adora, who nodded, "I'm okay, we have plenty of time. You can bring her in for a visit, Glimmer."

"Great, be right back!"

Two teleports later, the mothers felt their hearts break at the distressed kitten in their friend's arms, "Oh, baby.." Catra frowned, gently taking her into her arms.

"M-momma!"

"Shh, shh, shh.. It's okay, you're safe…" Catra cradled her close, kissing the top of her head gently, "What's the matter, little one..?"

"I- fought you w-weft me..!"

"Baby no…we would never!" Catra wiped her eyes, holding her baby close.

"We're sorry, little one. We didn't mean to make you feel that way." Adora frowned.

Sniffling, Mara buried her face into Catra's shirt. The way her claws dug into Catra's shirt made her heart ache, "It's okay… momma has you…"

"I wanna stay…" Mara whimpered.

Catra and Adora shared a look, "Mara, can you look at me please?"

Slowly, the kitten looked up at her mother.

"Mommy and I are currently…working on getting your little sibling, but we need to be alone for that."

Not understanding, Mara whimpered and tightened her hold. It only reminded Catra of the missing claw on her left hand, making it even harder to fathom letting her leave her sight.

"I promise as soon as we can, Auntie Glimmer or your grandpas will bring you right back to us, okay?"

"D-do you pwomise..?"

"I promise, sweetie. I would never make a promise to you I couldn't keep. Mommy wouldn't either. Okay?"

"Otay.."

Catra's ear flicked towards Adora when she heard a stifled gasp, "I'm gonna give you back to Auntie Glimmer now, and we'll see you soon. I love you, little one.." Catra smiled, kissing the top of her head.

"Wuv yous too.."

Mara didn't take her eyes off her moms until Glimmer teleported with her back out of the room.

Catra looked at Adora, who was breathing heavily once again. The brunette immediately offered her hand, "It's okay, baby, just breathe…"

⚔

It took nearly three more hours of on and off contractions before Adora dilated enough to actually start trying to give birth. Another half hour was spent before Adora's screams were replaced with an infant's cries.

"You did it Adora, you-" Catra looked away from the doctor to see Adora unconscious and smiled, "I'm so proud of you…" She whispered, kissing her fiance's forehead.

"Princess Catra?"

Turning, Catra gasped upon seeing a tiny magicat, smaller than most, swaddled in a sage green blanket. Most kittens were small, but Adora had given birth almost a month early, so the infant was barely four pounds.

"They're perfectly healthy." Doctor Althea smiled, "Would you like to hold them?"

"Please…" Catra held her arms out, gently taking the baby into her arms and cradling them to her chest.

The kitten yawned, sniffing the air and nuzzling into her chest.

"You're so beautiful, Finn…" She whispered, tears running down her face, “I know mommy will be so excited to meet you…”

“Speaking of, mom is also perfectly healthy, just extremely exhausted.” Althea chuckled.

“I figured. Would it be okay to let my dads bring Mara in..?”

“Of course, I’ll go send them in,”

⚔

“Momma!”

“Hey, little one. I have someone for you to meet…” Catra smiled. She could see tears already running down her father’s faces.

“Glimmer is offended she isn’t allowed in yet.” Ezekiel chuckled, taking a seat with his husband in the chairs next to their daughter.

“She’ll live.” Catra playfully scoffed, “Would you like to meet your little sibling, Mara?”

Gasping, the kitten’s tail began wagging as she nodded quickly, “Sibbing!”

“This is Finn..” Catra smiled, scooting a little closer to give her daughter a proper view of the sleeping infant in her arms.

Mara’s eyes practically sparkled with fascination, “Finn…!” She whispered, gently placing her hand against the blanket swaddling them. Both kittens began purring, absolutely melting the hearts of the adults in the room, “I wuv them..”

“I’m so happy to hear that, baby..” Catra whispered, kissing the top of her head and trying to will herself not to cry again.

“How long do you think Adora will be sleeping for?” Cyrus asked.

“I wouldn’t be surprised if she was out the rest of the day.” Catra laughed, glancing over as her sleeping fiance, “She needs the rest anyway.”

“She does,” Ezekiel hummed, cradling Mara to his chest once she’s pulled away from Finn, “We are very proud of both of you though.”

“Thanks, dad..” Catra smiled, leaning back against her chair. The magicats continued to talk for a while, letting Adora get some much needed rest, and Finn to adjust to a brand new world.

Back Home

Chapter Summary

Catra and Adora finally get to bring their family home.

Chapter Notes

There's only one chapter left and it will be a very adorable epilogue, so enjoy this cuteness

When Adora finally began to wake up, the whispers of her surrounding family found her ears. She slowly opened her eyes, glancing over at her fiance and future in-laws. She gasped when she saw the tiny bundle in Catra's arms.

"Hey, Adora…" Catra whispered, gazing at her with a loving smile, "Good morning."

"Morning..?" She finally took notice of Mara now in her pajamas, sleeping peacefully in a portable crib that had been brought in and placed next to Cyrus' chair. Catra herself was in shorts and one of Adora's old compression tops. The kings were the only two actually dressed.

"You were exhausted, it's alright." Catra hummed, watching her fiance shift to prop herself slightly against her pillows. The brunette could read the look in her eyes like an open book, "Are you sure you're okay to hold them now?"

Adora quickly nodded, "Please…"

"Okay.." Slowly, Catra got to her feet, and carefully lowered Finn into Adora's arms.

The blonde held the bundle with extreme care, tearing up as they stirred from their sleep.

Mewling, Finn sniffed the air, their paw lightly gripping onto Adora's hospital gown. They quickly recognized the scent as mommy, and they quickly settled back in their blanket, purring ever so slightly.

Adora couldn't hold back tears any longer as she looked up at Catra, smiling softly, "They're so beautiful…"

"They are…you did such an amazing job, princess.." Catra smiled, leaning down to press a kiss to her forehead, "Would you be alright letting Glimmer and Bow in? Sparkles has been losing her mind."

Adora snorted, nodding, "Of course. Thank you for waiting until I woke up though."

"Well I wasn't gonna let them see our baby before you."

Smiling, the blonde cradled her kitten while Catra stepped out to bring their friends in.

“It’s about time we get to see our new little nibbling,” Glimmer whispered, pouting as she walked in behind Catra, hand in hand with Bow.

“I’m sorry for your painful wait.” Adora replied sarcastically, giggling when the queen rolled her eyes, stealing Catra's chair so she could see the baby.

"Awe…!" She gasped, "They're precious!"

Bow was already crying, cooing over the kitten with sparkling eyes, "They're so tInY!" He squeaked, "The little ears…!"

Finn stirred, yawning as they rubbed their face against Adora's chest, scent marking her.

"I'm here, little one…" She whispered, kissing the top of their head.

"How did Mara react?" Glimmer asked, looking at Catra.

"Really well, she fell in love the second she saw them."

"Awee, I'm glad to hear that." She hummed, glancing over at Mara, who was still curled up against her plushie Mew Mew, fast asleep.

"I can't wait to get home and recover there though… I miss our cottage so much…" Adora admitted, not taking her eyes off of Finn.

"We'll be able to soon. Actually-" Catra turned to her dads, "We have an extra room, if you'd like to stay with us until the castle is rebuilt."

"We'd be honored to assist with the kittens, so of course." Ezekiel smiled, nodding.

⚔

Catra and her fathers spent the next week preparing the cottage before Adora and the kittens could finally come home as well.

Despite Adora’s protests, Catra made her sit in the wheelchair on the ride home, though the blonde was quick to move to the couch the moment they got inside.

“She had to use this thing a while ago for recovery.. She isn’t its biggest fan,” Catra chuckled sadly when her fathers gave her a questioning look.

“It was torture!” Adora whined, cradling Finn to her chest as they breastfed. She carefully adjusted the blanket cover with her free hand.

“I’m sorry baby, I’ll get it out of your sight,” Catra laughed, folding the wheelchair and carrying it out of the room to put it away in the hallway closet.

“Thank you..” Adora smiled, returning her attention to Finn, who was finally starting to slow down.

"Mommy?" Mara asked, having finally wiggled out of Cyrus' arms and crawled over to the couch.

"Yes, sweetness?" Adora asked, looking down at her.

"Can I see my sibbing?"

"In just a moment, they're being fed right now."

"How?" Mara asked, tilting her head. She squeaked when Catra lifted her up and sat on the couch, setting her in her lap.

"Mommy breastfeeds her." Catra explained, knowing Mara wouldn't understand but wanted to be honest anyway.

"Ooohh…" It was clear Mara didn't know what that meant, but pretended to anyway, much to the adults' amusement.

When Finn was finally done, Adora gently burped them, setting the blanket aside after fixing her top, then finally cradled the kitten to her chest.

"Finny!" Mara smiled, purring.

Finn chirped in return, purring themselves as she curled up in Adora's arms.

Mara mewled, her tail wagging as she watched her sibling with interest.

"You two are adorable." Adora smiled, giggling when Finn yawned, stretching their little arms before curling up, "I think it's nap time for my little kittens."

Mara yawned as well, rubbing her eyes, "Can I seep wif Finny?"

"Sure sweetie." Adora smiled, carefully getting to her feet.

"Adora-"

"I'm fine, Catra. Wanna help with Mara?"

"Okay, okay.." Catra smiled, lifting Mara into her arms, "We'll be back," She said to her dads before the couple left the room, heading down to their own bedroom.

Adora carefully swaddled Finn before laying them down in the crib next to Mara who immediately cuddled up to them, both purring softly.

"Sleep well, my loves." Adora smiled, giving both of them a kiss on the forehead, Catra doing the same before they stepped out of the room and closed the door, walking hand in hand back to the living room.

United Kingdoms

Chapter Summary

> “Today is one that could not have been possible without these two beautiful women, and the love and friendship they share with everyone around them today. Together, they put an end to the Battle for Etheria because of the raw, powerful love that they share with each other, and were able to come together despite the unfortunate circumstances. If it weren’t for these two, I would have never been reunited with my daughter, and none of us would know life without war, or the beautiful kingdom of Halfmoon as it slowly returns to its former glory.” Ezekiel took a deep breath, offering the couple a warm smile before continuing, “They have proven that heros can arise from anywhere, no matter what background they come from. Today, it is my greatest honor to officiate the reunion of their most hard fought war.”

Chapter Notes

> The final chapter is HERE! The moment I finished writing this I actually wanted to cry lol. I hope you all enjoy!!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

It took three years before the Halfmoon Palace was finally completed. The Royal Family had to carefully delegate their time to assisting in construction, raising the kittens, and preparing for the first event that was to take place upon its completion.

The day came sooner than Adora expected it to. She'd spent so many hours picking color schemes and types of flowers with Catra, dress shopping with her friends, and overseeing decorations in Halfmoon to even recognize the days passing and her- their special day approaching. Before she knew it, she was standing in front of a large three panel mirror, in a beautiful white

dress that hugged her hips and flowed behind her, gently laying on the ground as Glimmer and Perfuma continued to adjust the gown. The sweetheart neckline allowed the scar of the Failsafe to be on full display, as per Adora’s request. Though the scar was faint now, it was still a reminder of where she’d been, and the progress she had made now. She smiled, her thoughts moving away from her scars when Glimmer stepped in front of her, adjusting the sash they’d added to represent Halfmoon’s culture, "Uhm, guys? Don't you think it's as good as it's gonna get?" Adora questioned, giving a sheepish grin.

"It has to be perfect! I will accept no less!" Glimmer declared, adjusting the tiara that held the veil atop Adora's head.

"Okay, okay!" Adora giggled, smiling at her reflection.

"There!" Glimmer took a step back, admiring her work.

"You look beautiful, Adora. Catra's gonna fall in love all over again when she sees you." Perfuma mused, growing a white rose and adding it to the bouquet.

“You look soooo pwetty mommy!” Mara exclaimed from her seat on the floor next to the mirror.

"Thank you baby…” She smiled, “And, I can't wait to see her too…" The couple had been separated the night before due to tradition, as Glimmer put it, and Adora had hated every second of

it. She had Mara to help, as Catra had Finn, but she still didn't understand why the dumb tradition existed.

"Wait! One more thing." The queen stepped forward to adjust the off the shoulder half sleeves of the wedding dress.

"Glimmer…" Adora groaned.

"Oh shh, I was just fixing your sleeve. *Now* I'm finished."

Adora sighed in relief and stepped down, "I haven't even walked down the aisle and my feet are already killing me."

"I told you heels weren't a good idea Glimmer." Perfuma stated softly, though her tone made it clear she was quietly saying *I told you so* , before guiding Adora to a chair, "She's never liked the things to begin with."

Blushing, Adora's turned her attention to Mara, who was now busy with her plushie, Mew Mew.

Glimmer only rolled her eyes before teleporting out and back into the room, returning with a pair of flat, golden sandals. She helped Adora swap shoes before tossing the others aside, "Better?"

“Much, thank you.” Adora smiled, “How much longer before the ceremony starts again?”

“Not too much longer. Once Catra finishes up and gets out there, we can start.” Perfuma informed, handing the bride her flower bouquet.

"And Finn is with-"

"-With Spinnerella and Netossa in the courtyard. They’re okay.”

Adora smiled, a tender hold on the flowers as she stole a final glance at herself in the mirror before taking a deep breath, and turning towards her friends. Mara was old enough that they decided to make her the flower kitten, but Finn was still struggling to walk, so they would spend the day with their aunties until the reception. Her smile grew when the door opened to reveal Bow, who looked overjoyed himself, “Alright, Catra’s at the altar; we’re ready to start!”

Eyes lighting up, the blonde nodded and made her way to the door in the quickest stride she could in what felt like a twenty pound dress, “What are we waiting for then? Let’s go!”

Giggling at her enthusiasm, Glimmer hurried over to the bride’s side, Perfuma following after picking up Mara,“Alright slow down!” The queen laughed, “The last thing we need is for you to trip.”

“I’ll be fine! If I have to wait any longer to see my fiancée, or my other baby for that matter, I might actually lose my mind.” She couldn’t help but pout at the laughter she received in response, but brushed it off since they all left the room quickly after to get to the Halfmoon courtyard.

⚔

Catra’s anxious purring could only be heard by those standing at the altar, but any of the attending guests could sense her nerves from all across Etheria, “Everything okay, Catra?” Ezekiel whispered.

“I’m fine, dad.” The magicat replied, smiling softly, “I just miss her and- I’m a little nervous.” She stole a look at her kitten in the front row of guests, cradled in Spinnerella's arms, peacefully napping. The sight brought a smile to her face for a moment. She carefully adjusted her outfit. Her fathers had helped her design traditional Halfmoon wedding attire. With loose-fitting pants and a form fitting top. Both the top and pants were white, a golden and burgundy sash wrapping over her shoulder. Her hair was down, two braids on either side of her face. She had small jewels in the braids as well that complimented the sash.

“What’s there to be nervous about, kitten?” Double Trouble, one of her attendants, cut in, a teasing expression matching their tone, “Afraid of getting too… excited before the honeymoon?”

“Gh- Dee!” Catra blushed, glaring at her snickering father, “No! I just- I dunno!” She was still whispering, but now it had escalated to more of a whisper-shout.

“Don’t mess this day up, I will sting you.” Scorpia threatened, “I am her best woman and I am taking the job seriously.”

“Easy, big girl. They were just teasing me. Right?” Catra squinted, furrowing her eyebrows as she looked back at Double Trouble.

“Hm? Oh, of course!” They assured, but their expression wasn’t really helping their case. At least nothing else was said on the subject before her other attendant, Entrapta interrupted.

“I would end this conversation soon because the event is starting!” She too was whisper-shouting out of excitement for her friends.

“WhAt?” Catra squeaked, looking up to see Adora’s bridesmaids beginning their walk down the aisle. Perfuma and Glimmer made their way down, followed by Bow, Mara (who made her way to Spinnerella and Netossa after spreading the flowers as directed), Melog, their ring bearer, and then finally, Adora, flowers in one hand and Cyrus' arm in the other.

Catra’s breath caught in her throat when she laid eyes on her beautiful bride-to-be. The way her dress hugged her curves and flowed behind her and the way her curled hair rested over her

shoulders all but took her breath away. Adora nearly faltered when the couple finally made eye contact. Luckily, Cyrus was there to steady her. Cyrus gently passed Adora in Catra's arms when they reached the end of the aisle. Tears had already welled up in both women's eyes by the time they were close enough to hold hands, "You look so beautiful…" Adora whispered, unable to take her eyes off the attire the magicat was wearing.

"Speak for yourself, princess." Catra replied, brushing a strand of hair out of the blonde's face. Adora couldn't help but giggle a little at the compliment.

Once the two turned to look at Ezekiel, the king took that as his queue to begin the ceremony, "Today is one that could not have been possible without these two beautiful women, and the love and friendship they share with everyone around them today. Together, they put an end to the Battle for Etheria because of the raw, powerful love that they share with each other, and were able to come together despite the unfortunate circumstances. If it weren't for these two, I would have never been reunited with my daughter, and none of us would know life without war, or the beautiful kingdom of Halfmoon as it slowly returns to its former glory." Ezekiel took a deep breath, offering the couple a warm smile before continuing, "They have proven that heros can arise from anywhere, no matter what background they come from. Today, it is my greatest honor to officiate the reunion of their most hard fought war." He turned towards Adora, "Princess Adora, do you take Princess Catra to be your lawfully wedded wife, in sickness and health, until death do you part?"

"I do." Adora's voice was barely above a whisper. She still hadn't been able to break eye contact with the brunette, having to fight all instinct to just yank her into a kiss that moment.

Smiling, the king then turned to Catra, “And do you, Princess Catra, take Princess Adora to be your lawfully wedded wife, in sickness and health, until death do you part?”

“Of course I do.” Catra’s little smirk made Adora’s heart melt.

“In that case, may I have the rings please?”

With a meow, Melog stepped forward and presented the pillow holding the golden bands, which Ezekiel gratefully took before holding the rings out to the women, who tenderly slipped them onto each other’s ring finger, “It is my honor and my pleasure to announce Princesses Adora and Catra as officially married, you may now kiss the-“

The sentence didn’t need to be finished before Adora threw her arms around Catra’s shoulders and kissed her with as much love and passion as she could muster. The cheers of the crowd were drowned out as Catra wrapped her arms around Adora’s waist, holding her close as they quickly made up for all the kisses they missed the night before.

⚔

“This is so perfect…”

“What’s perfect, princess?”

“Everything…” Adora giggled, nuzzling her face into Catra’s shoulder as the latter led them in their first dance.

“The others really did an amazing job…” Catra mused before lowering her voice, wanting only her wife to hear, “Is it bad that I’m really just looking forward to tonight?”

“You aren’t the only one…” Adora hummed, extremely grateful she'd been convinced to wear her knee brace underneath her dress, "Our first night with a babysitter? Amazing."

"And terrifying?"

"Absolutely."

As their dance came to a close, the two shared a sweet kiss before heading over to cut the cake together. Of course, Adora decided they had to use her sword, which resulted in very uneven slices, but nobody seemed to mind. The blonde was just glad to sit down and eat and rest.

"Is your leg acting up again?" She asked gently, taking a seat next to her.

"Maybe a little, I'll be fine. I'm mostly hungry honestly." Adora blushed, squeaking when Catra fed her a bite of cake.

"That better, princess?"

Nodding, Adora giggled, her attention only stolen by familiar voices, "Mommys!" Mara was walking over, Glimmer holding Finn's arms so they would waddle along as well.

"Hey babys!" Adora smiled, lifting Finn into her arms while Mara climbed into Catra's.

"You look so pwetty!" Mara smiled, hugging Catra, "I was hopin to dances too!"

"Awe sweetie, of course." Catra laughed, looking at Adora, "Will you be okay?" She asked, still concerned about Adora's leg.

"I'm fine, baby, I promise." Adora laughed, kissing Finn's forehead when they began purring in her arms.

"I'll sit with her if it'll make you feel better." Glimmer offered, taking the seat Catra was in after she got up.

"Thanks, Sparkles." Catra smiled, kissing Adora's forehead before walking over to the dancefloor, swaying a giggling Mara in her arms.

Adora watched the two with a bright smile, loving filling her gaze.

"I'm really happy for you, Adora."

"Thanks Glimmer," Adora smiled, blushing softly, "I never thought something like this would be possible."

"You two deserve it. I never thought I'd trust Catra, but I not only trust her with my life, but to help me run Brightmoon. Speaking of, do you two think you'll stay at the cottage?"

"Huh? Yeah..?"

"I ask because- well, Halfmoon is recovering well, and Catra would be next in line when her fathers retire.."

"I hadn't thought about that. I guess it'll be up to Catra. If she wants to take the throne and move here then I'm happy to follow."

"Well, whatever you choose, I know the kits will be safe and happy. Isn't that right, Finny?" She cooed.

Giggling and blowing a raspberry, Finn nodded and curled up more against Adora, "Dress soft…"

"Yeah..?" Adora chuckled, ruffling their hair.

"Yah!" They smiled, before beginning to teeth on their hand.

Adora hummed, cradling them close to her, "Ooh I'm gonna miss you two so much while we're in Mystacor!"

"Don't worry, you two can call on the trackerpad every day." Netossa cut in as she approached, Spinnerella at her side.

"We will definitely do that." Adora blushed.

"You got that right." Catra added, Mara in her arms, "But we'll only be gone a week. They'll be okay with their aunties, won't you, Mara?"

"Mhm!" Mara smiled. The progress she'd made over time with her physical development, trust, and healing from her trauma was truly miraculous, "Don't worry mommy!"

Slowly standing, Adora approached and kissed Mara on the forehead, still holding Finn. All three magicats were purring, and Adora couldn't feel more at home.

⚔

"Promise you'll be good for your aunties." Catra said as she finally passed Finn into Spinnerella's arms.

"We promise mama!" Mara smiled, letting go from hugging Adora's leg and stepping back to hug Netossa's.

"Thank you, Mara. We love you, and we'll call tomorrow, okay?" Adora promised.

"Okay!"

After getting another hug from both her moms, and Finn getting a final moment of cuddles, the newlyweds finally departed, making their way to Mystacor on Swift Wind, ready to enjoy the rest of their lives together.

This family, was a promise that they intended to keep.

Chapter End Notes

Thank you so much for reading. Comments, Kudos, all make my week!

Thank you all for coming on this journey of an AU with me!

I plan to dive into working on The Horde's Princess now, as well as a few other AUs I haven't posted yet. I can't wait to share them with you all! <3

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!